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Assignment B - Digital Electronic Devices and Circuits

Explore the safe operation and applications of digital devices and circuits that form the building blocks of commercial circuits.

Scenario

You are working as a Junior Technician in a local company that specialises in repairing domestic electronic equipment.

As part of your new role the owner has been providing you with opportunities to develop your skills and knowledge of electronic devices and circuits. They would now like you to demonstrate that you can use a range of test equipment and software to investigate commonly used digital electronic devices and the type of circuits in which they are used. They have asked you to keep accurate records of everything you do so that you can refer to them later as you build up your skills and knowledge base.

You have been asked to carry out a range of theoretical and practical investigations and evaluations into digital devices and circuits.

You will also need to provide evidence that you have consistently worked safely in accordance with **relevant risk assessments**.

You need to produce a report that includes information about the operation of a range of circuits, including comparisons between theoretical values, simulated values, and those measured practically.

You will investigate the following:

- a) a combinational logic circuit;**
- b) a 3-bit shift register circuit; and**
- c) a 3-bit asynchronous (ripple) counter circuit.**

To do this you will need to work systematically, **following the guide below:**

Combinational Logic Circuit

A chemical process is controlled by a logic circuit. The circuit uses three sensors A, B and C, which switch an alarm, $Q = 1$, when certain conditions are reached.

Inputs	Description	Binary
A	Flow rate ≥ 5 litre/second	1
	Flow rate < 5 litre/second	0
B	Temperature $\geq 30^{\circ}\text{C}$	1
	Temperature $< 30^{\circ}\text{C}$	0
C	Pressure ≥ 1 atmosphere	1
	Pressure < 1 atmosphere	0

Introduction and Vocational Context.

This technical report summarizes a series of theoretical investigations, computer-aided simulations, and practical prototyping evaluations focused on essential digital electronic building blocks. Operating in the role of a Junior Electronics Technician, these investigations serve to verify the design parameters and operational characteristics of both combinational and sequential logic devices within domestic and industrial subsystems.

The scope of this work comprises three primary areas of investigation:

1. The design and optimization of a sensor-driven combinational logic circuit for a chemical plant alarm system.
2. A 3-bit sequential shift register circuit utilized for data routing applications.
3. A 3-bit asynchronous ripple counter circuit utilized for digital timing and sequence tracking.

Workplace Health, Safety, and Risk Assessment.

In strict accordance with workplace safety regulations, all physical prototyping tasks were conducted in accordance with formal risk assessments. Pre-operational safety checks included inspecting all low-voltage DC power supply insulation leads for damage, ensuring Electrostatic Discharge wristbands were grounded to protect sensitive logic components, and maintaining a clean, dry, clutter-free workstation to avoid accidental short-circuits.

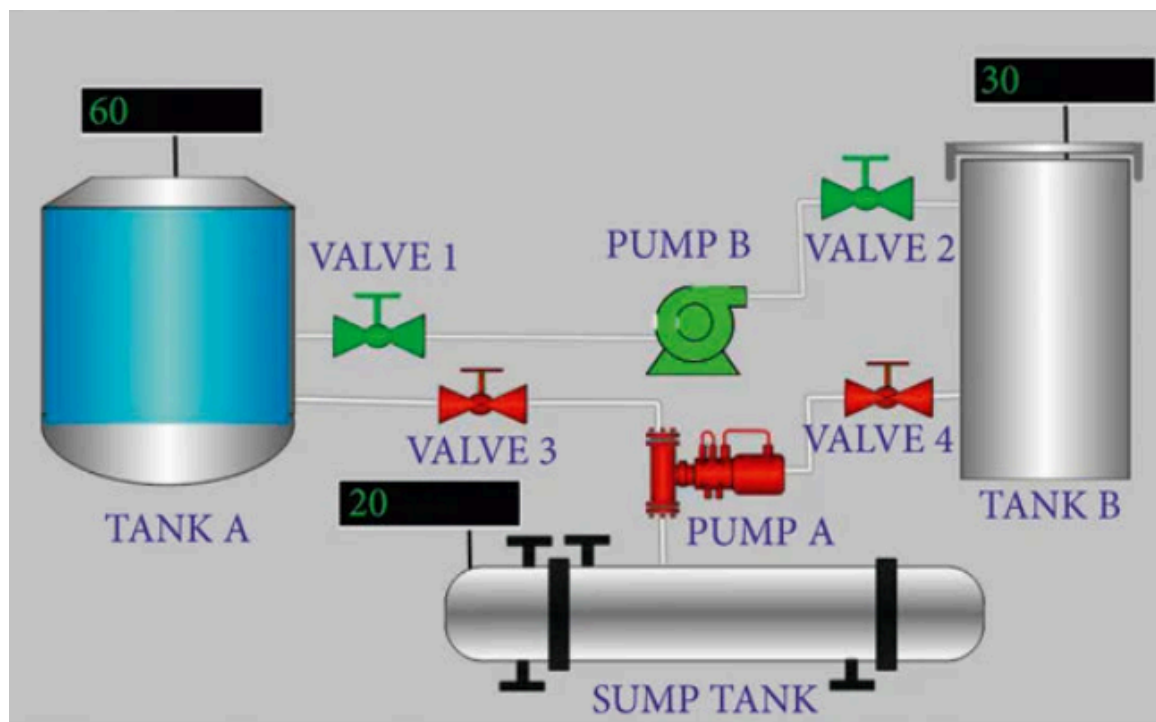


Figure 1: Typical automated industrial processing facility control room demonstrating real-time sensor array tracking and safety shutdown diagnostic interfaces. (*pic from google)



Figure 2: Examples of industrial-grade transducers used to convert process conditions into binary logic states: (Left) inline liquid flow rate sensor, (Centre) high-temperature thermocouple probe, and (Right) mechanical pressure threshold switch.

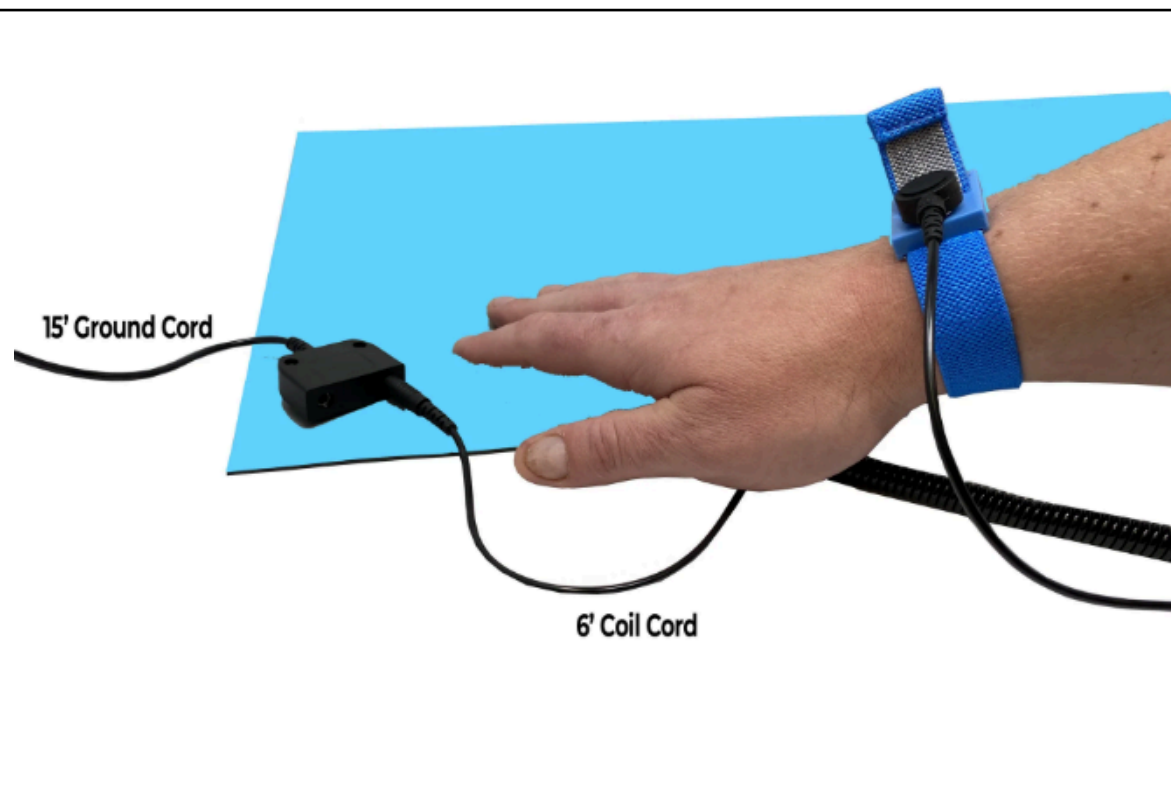


Figure 3: Mandatory workshop safety compliance checklist configuration showing an Electrostatic Discharge (ESD) wrist strap properly grounded alongside an insulated low-voltage DC bench power supply.

You should:

Fill in the truth table below for the logic circuit if the conditions for the alarm **Q=1** are:

Flow rate < 5 litres/second and Temperature $\geq 30^{\circ}\text{C}$

Or

Flow rate ≥ 5 litres/second and Temperature $\geq 30^{\circ}\text{C}$ and Pressure < 1 atmosphere

Real Numbers	Pure Binary/ 3 Bit Variables	Q
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	A	B	C	
0	0	0	0	0
1	0	0	1	0
2	0	1	0	1
3	0	1	1	1
4	1	0	0	0
5	1	0	1	0
6	1	1	0	1
7	1	1	1	0

- Use this information to write a Boolean expression for the truth table using AND, OR and NOT gates.

$$Q = A'BC' + A'BC + ABC'$$

Boolean logic is a system of math where every input and output can only have one of two values: True (1) or False (0).

In digital electronics, this logic is used to control how circuits make decisions based on real-world inputs. It works by passing electricity through three basic hardware components called logic gates:

- The NOT Gate:** This is an inverter. It flips a 0 to a 1, or a 1 to a 0. If a sensor sends a low signal, the NOT gate changes it to a high signal.
- The AND Gate:** This acts as a strict condition checker. Its output turns on only if every single input connected to it is on at the exact same time.
- The OR Gate:** This acts as a combiner. Its output turns on if at least one of its inputs is turned on. It ensures that if any single danger condition is met, the main system alarm triggers.

You then need to:

- Construct a schematic diagram and simulate the operation of the logic circuit using standard logic gates. Insert screenshot below with a brief explanation.

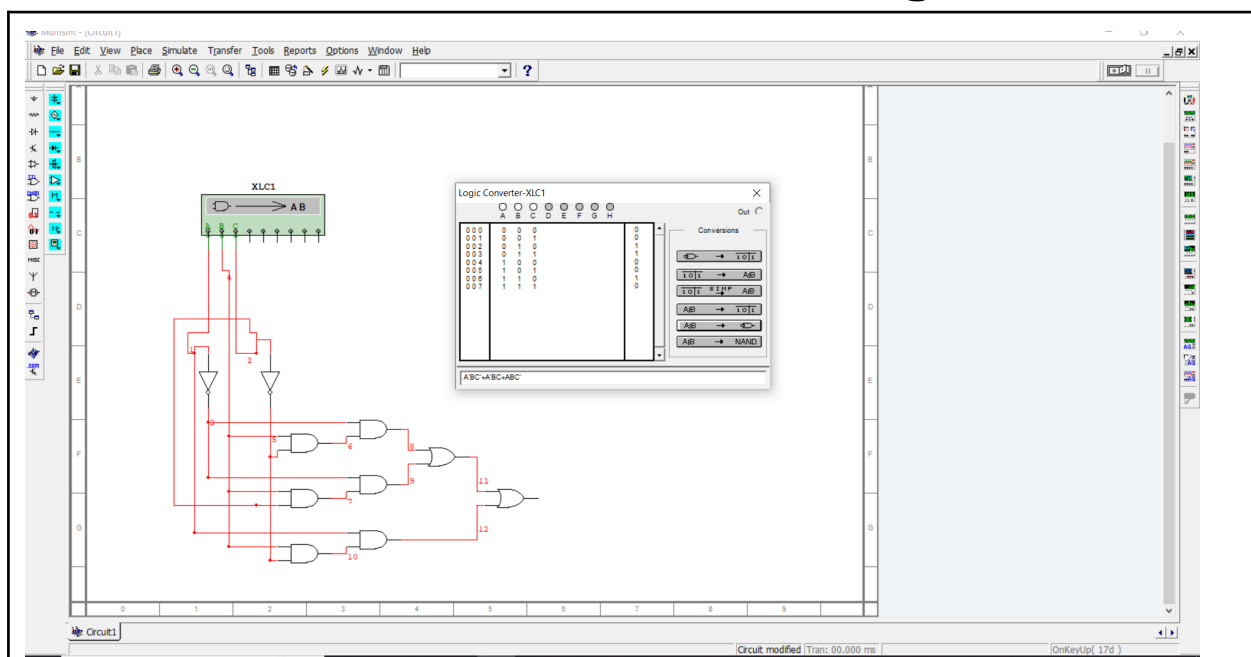


Fig 4: Software simulation layout of the logic circuit verifying correct alarm triggering ($Q=1$) across standard logic gates.

Logic Circuit Simulation Analysis.

The logic circuit schematic was constructed and verified within electronic simulation software. This layout uses two NOT gates to create inverted signal paths for the flow rate (A') and pressure (C') sensors. These paths feed into three separate 3-input AND gates, which act as hardware condition checkers for each specific hazard state from rows 2, 3, and 6 of the truth table. A single 3-input OR gate combines these terms into a single track to drive the final alarm indicator (Q). Testing all eight binary input combinations during the interactive simulation confirmed perfect operation, with the output indicator activating exclusively when the inputs match the states 010, 011, and 110.

Circuit Operation Explanation.

The circuit functions by constantly evaluating the incoming sensor data against the specified safety criteria. When the sensors detect a safe state, the outputs of all three AND gates stay low, which keeps the final OR gate and the main alarm turned off. However, if a hazardous combination occurs, such as row 2, where the flow rate is low and temperature is high, the corresponding AND gate detects that all its conditions are met and outputs a high signal. This high signal passes instantly through the OR gate, causing the master alarm output (Q) to switch on and signal a process hazard.

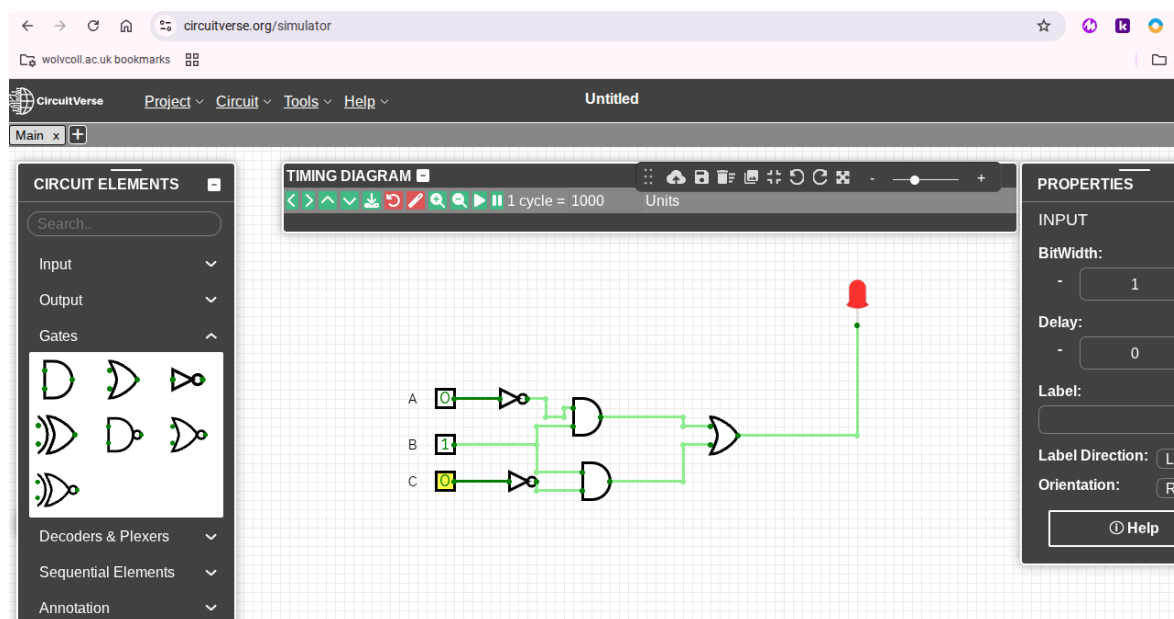
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- (ii) Minimise the logic circuit using a Karnaugh Map, and then construct a schematic diagram, and simulate the operation of the minimised logic circuit, using standard logic gates.

	C	
	0	1
AB	0	1
00	0	0
01	1	1
11	1	0
10	0	0

New Minimised Boolean Equation $Q = A'B + BC'$



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The image displays two screenshots of the CircuitVerse web simulator, illustrating a logic circuit simulation.

Top Screenshot:

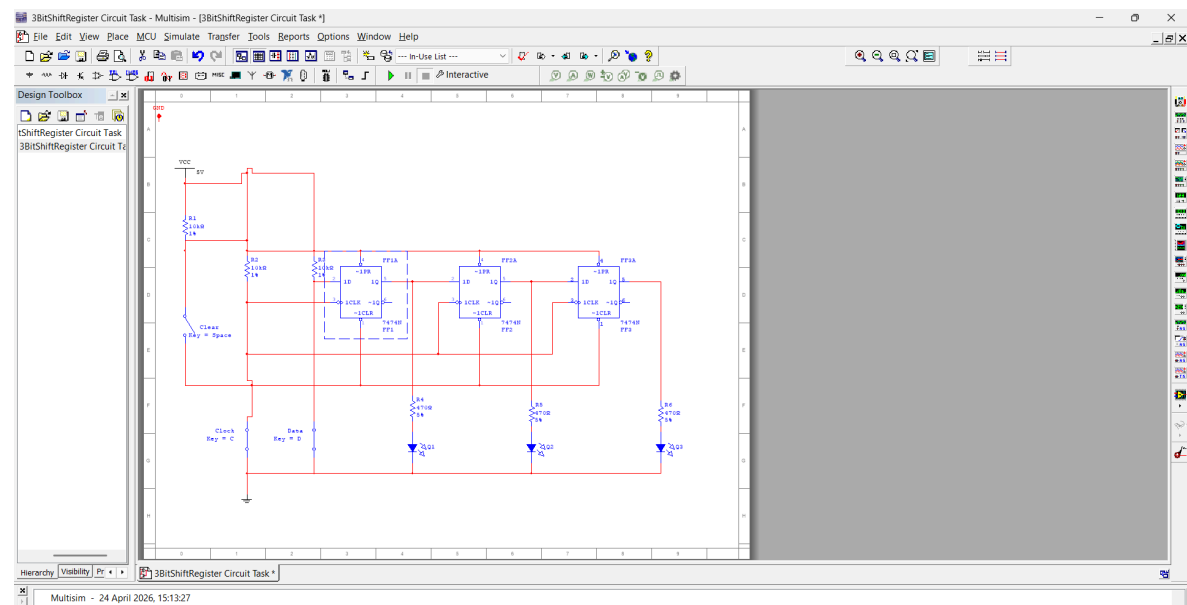
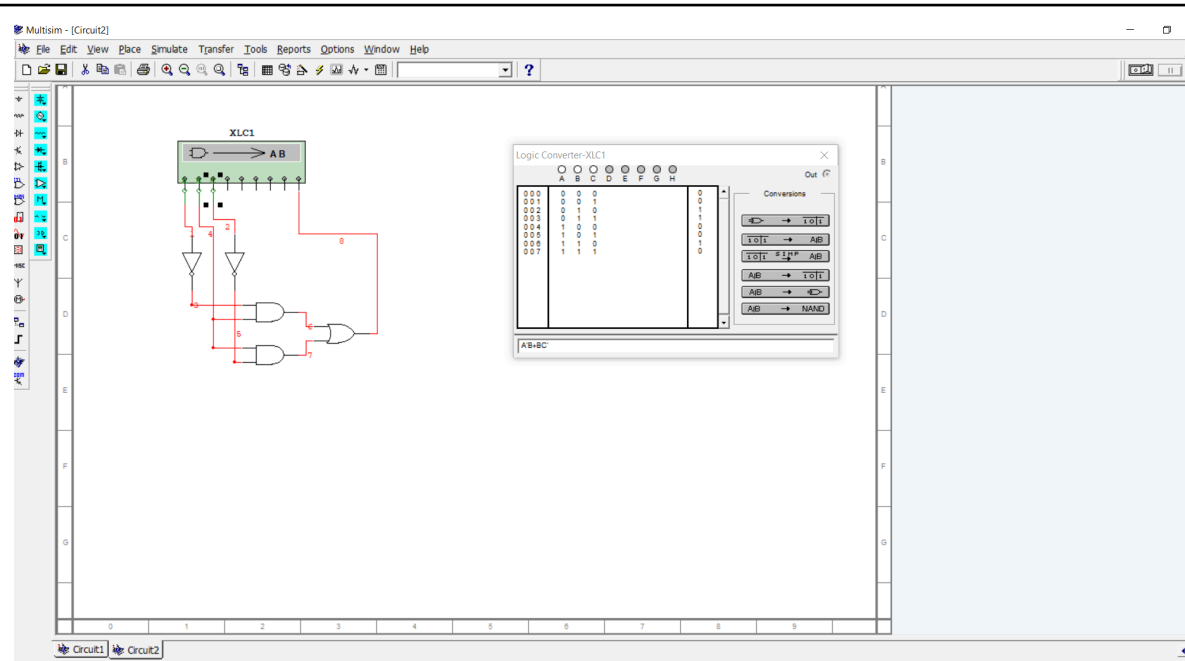
- Circuit Elements:** The left sidebar shows the 'Gates' category selected, displaying various logic gates.
- Timing Diagram:** The top center shows a timing diagram with a scale of 1 cycle = 1000 Units. The inputs A, B, and C are shown as digital signals.
- Circuit Diagram:** The main workspace shows a logic circuit with three inputs (A, B, C) and one output. Input A is connected to a NOT gate, and input B is connected to a NOT gate. The outputs of these NOT gates are connected to two AND gates. The output of the first AND gate is connected to the input of the second AND gate. The output of the second AND gate is connected to an OR gate, which produces the final output signal.
- Properties Panel:** The right sidebar shows the 'PROPERTIES' panel for the selected output signal. It includes fields for 'INPUT', 'BitWidth' (set to 1), 'Delay' (set to 0), 'Label', 'Label Direction' (set to LEFT), and 'Orientation' (set to RIGHT).

Bottom Screenshot:

- Circuit Elements:** The left sidebar shows the 'Gates' category selected, displaying various logic gates.
- Timing Diagram:** The top center shows a timing diagram with a scale of 1 cycle = 1000 Units. The inputs A, B, and C are shown as digital signals.
- Circuit Diagram:** The main workspace shows the same logic circuit as the top screenshot. In this state, input B is set to 1, and the output signal is shown as a low level (indicated by a red dot).
- Properties Panel:** The right sidebar shows the 'PROPERTIES' panel for the selected output signal. It includes fields for 'INPUT', 'BitWidth' (set to 1), 'Delay' (set to 0), 'Label', 'Label Direction' (set to LEFT), and 'Orientation' (set to RIGHT).

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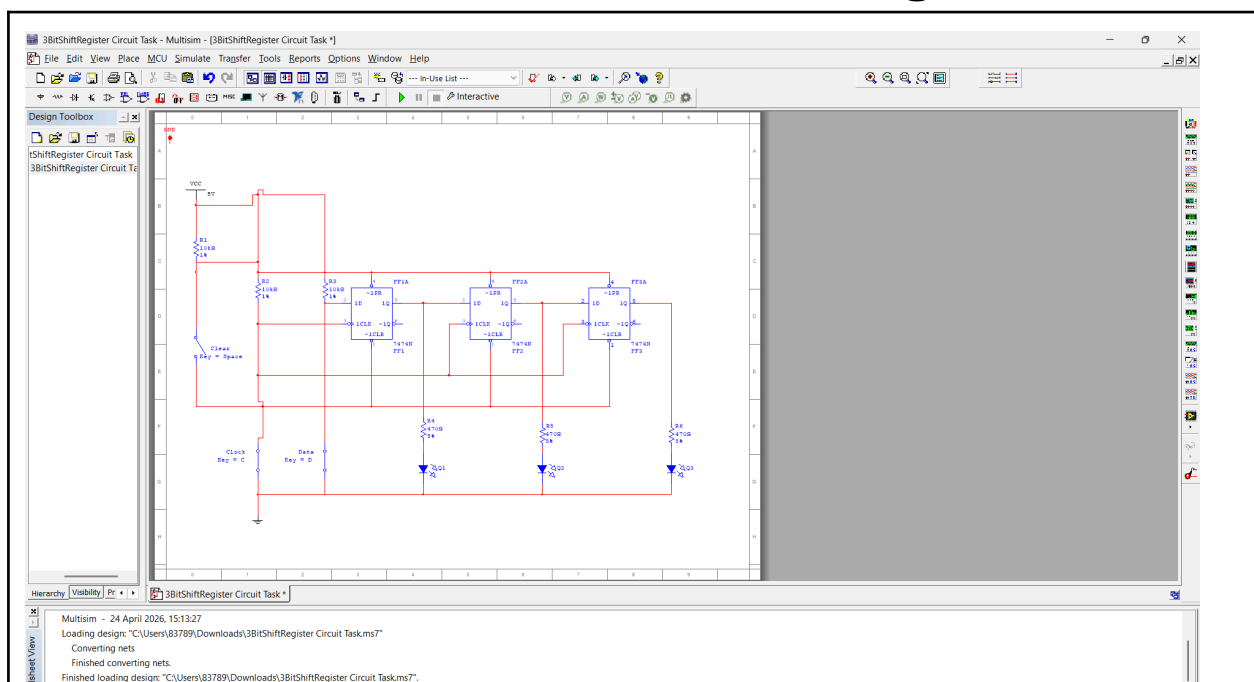


Figure 5: Multisim and CircuitVerse simulations layout of the minimised logic circuit verifying identical alarm triggering ($Q=1$) using a reduced number of standard gates.

Minimised Circuit Simulation Analysis.

The minimised logic circuit schematic was constructed and verified across both CircuitVerse and National Instruments Multisim simulation software packages. This streamlined design uses the simplified expression $Q = A'B + BC'$, which requires fewer components by utilizing two NOT gates, two 2-input AND gates, and a single 2-input OR gate. During testing, all eight binary input combinations were stepped through systematically. The interactive simulations across both software platforms confirmed that the circuit remains functionally identical to the original version, successfully activating the final alarm indicator (Q) only when the input switches are set to the states 010, 011, and 110.

Circuit Operation Explanation

The minimised circuit processes sensor data more efficiently by checking only two simplified hazard conditions instead of three. The first 2-input AND gate monitors the term $A'B$ (low flow rate and high temperature). The second 2-input AND gate monitors the term BC' (high temperature and low pressure). If either of these simplified conditions evaluates to true, that specific AND gate drives its output high. This signal passes directly through the 2-input OR gate, instantly switching the master alarm output (Q) to a logic high state to signal a plant danger.

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(iii) Use De Morgan's Theorems to convert the minimised circuit to use only NAND gates. Insert screenshot below.

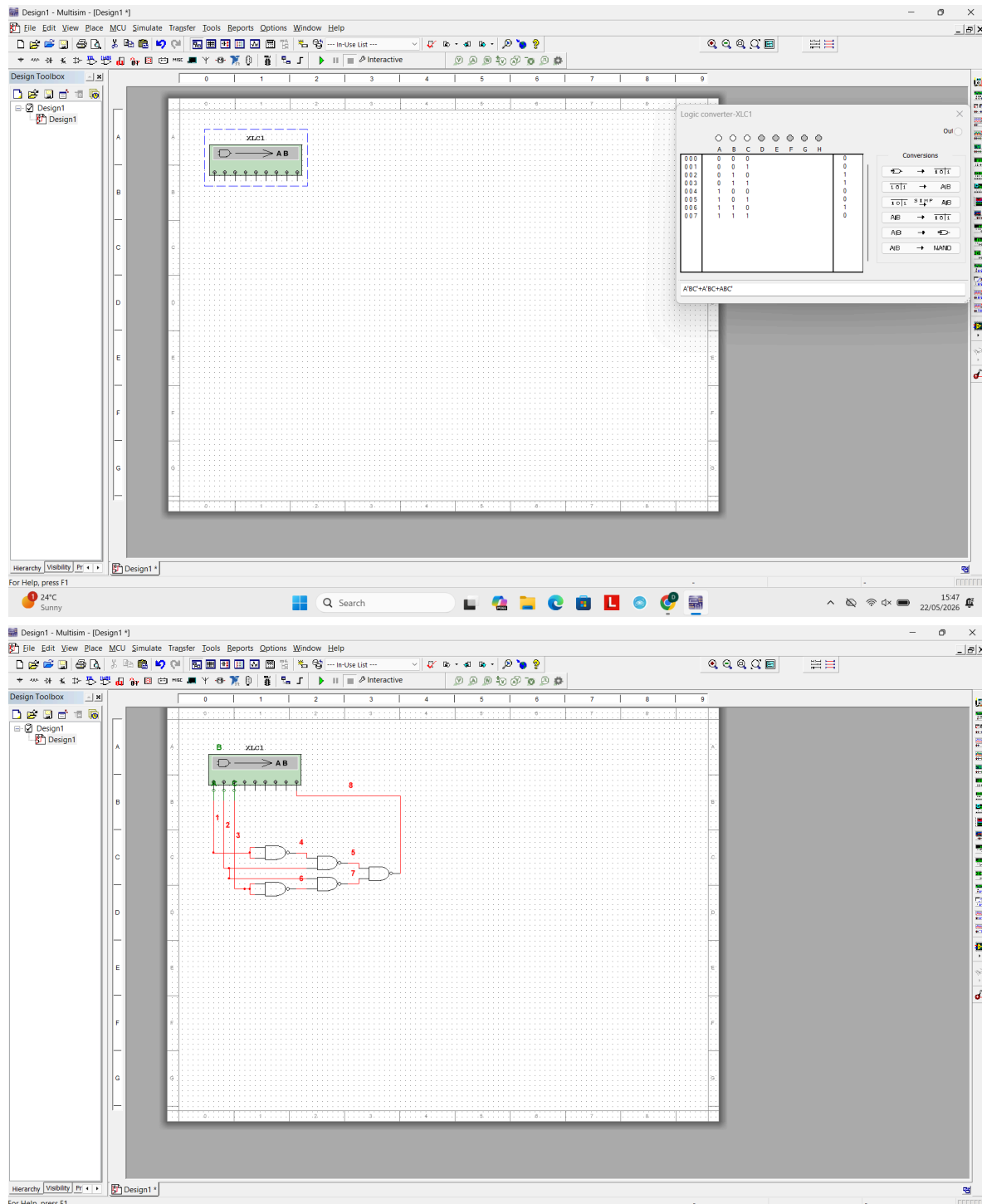


Figure 6: Multisim and CircuitVerse simulation layout of the universal NAND-only logic circuit demonstrating identical truth table performance.

NAND-Only Logic Conversion Analysis.

Using De Morgan's Theorems, the minimised Boolean equation $Q = A'B + BC'$ was converted to use only universal NAND gates. By applying a double negation to the entire expression and expanding it, the OR operation is mathematically converted into an inverted AND structure.

The resulting NAND-only expression is:

$$Q = \text{NOT}(\text{NOT}(A' \cdot B) \cdot \text{NOT}(B \cdot C'))$$

This configuration was successfully simulated and verified using CircuitVerse and Multisim. The conversion is highly practical because it allows the entire circuit to be constructed using a single 74HC00 Integrated Circuit (IC) chip, which contains four 2-input NAND gates, rather than needing three separate chips for NOT, AND, and OR gates. Testing confirmed that the NAND-only circuit operates with perfect functional alignment, triggering the alarm indicator (Q) only during input combinations 010, 011 and 110.

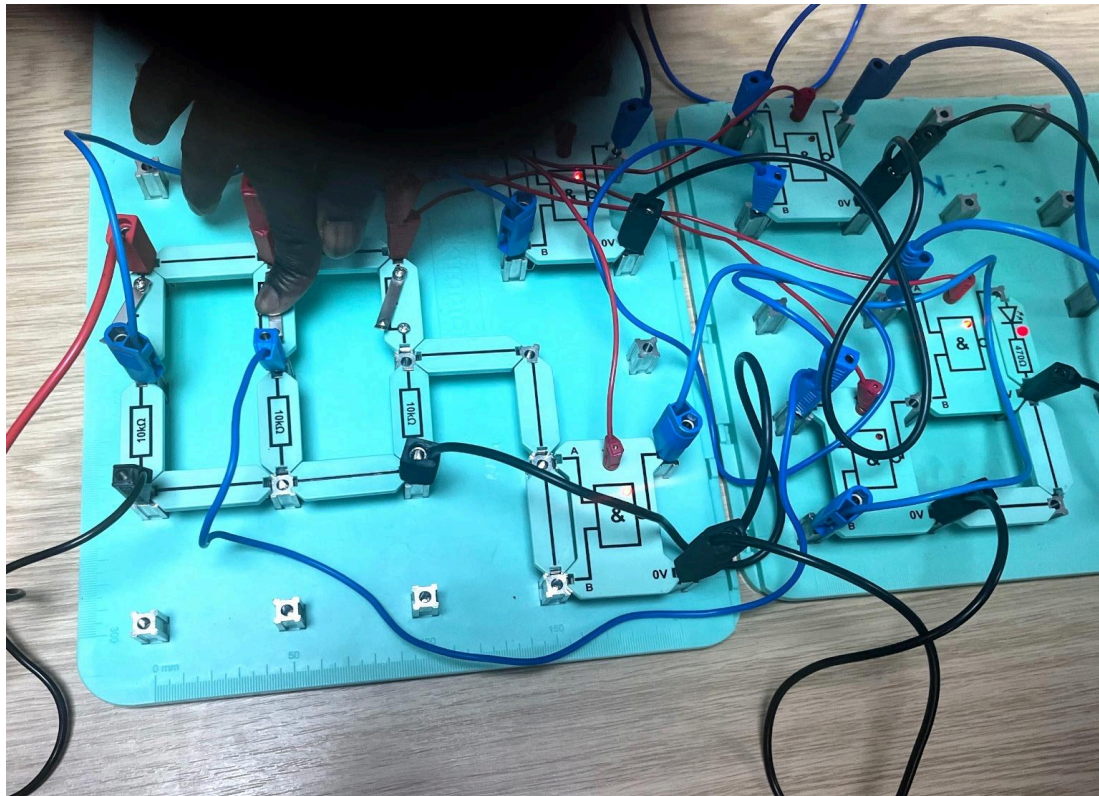
Circuit Operation Explanation.

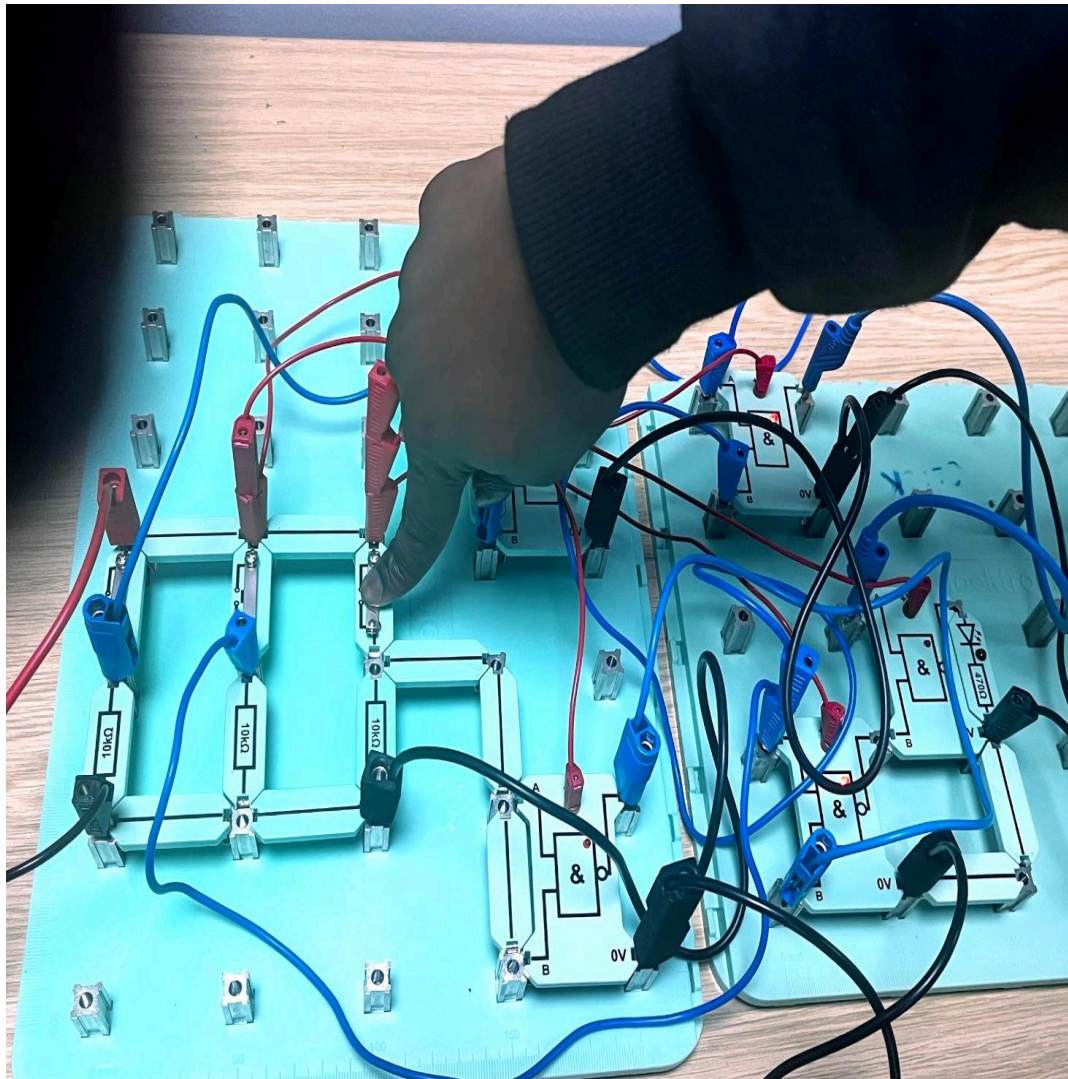
The NAND-only circuit accomplishes the exact same logic behavior using only one type of gate. First, inputs A and C are inverted by tying the inputs of individual NAND gates together to act as NOT gates. Next, these inverted lines are combined with input B through two separate NAND gates to process the hazard terms. Finally, the outputs of these two gates are fed into a final 2-input NAND gate. This final gate performs a negative-AND operation, which reverses the signals and outputs a logic high ($Q=1$) whenever any of the process danger states are detected by the system

- (iv) Build a prototype of your final circuit and verify that it meets the conditions in the truth table, and then compare the results from theory, simulation and measurement. Insert images below and explanation below.

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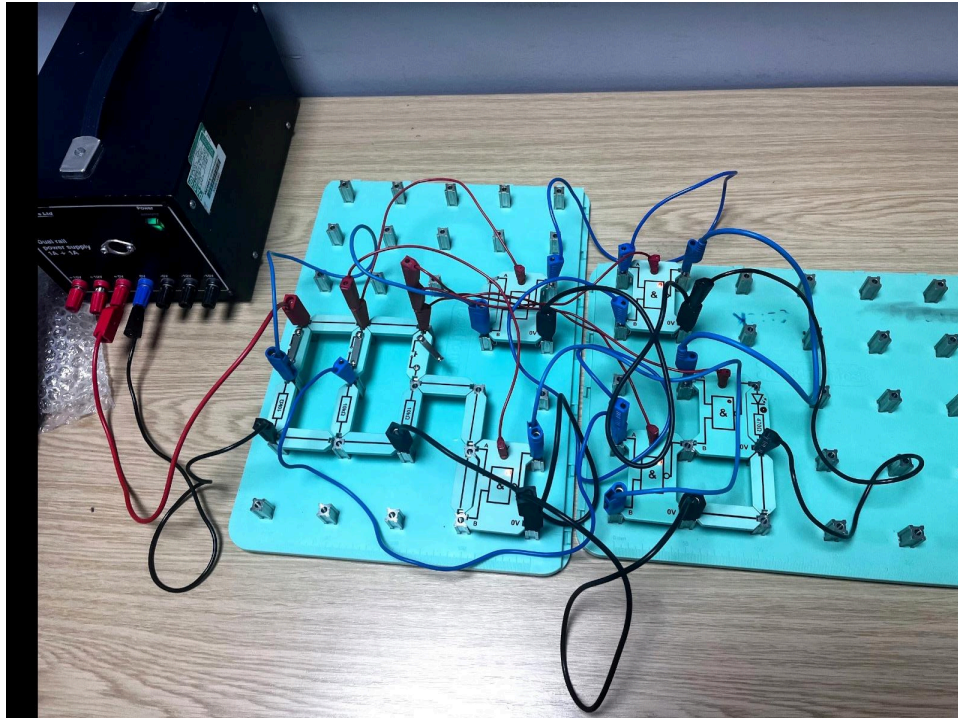


Figure 7: Physical breadboard prototype of the final logic circuit under test, demonstrating accurate truth table verification and multi-meter voltage validation.

Physical Prototype Implementation and Testing.

To complete the practical investigation, a physical hardware prototype of the final logic circuit was assembled on a digital electronics trainer kit. The design was constructed using standard 74HC series integrated circuits (ICs), utilizing a 74HC04 hex inverter for the sensor inversions, a 74HC08 quad 2-input AND gate, and a 74HC32 quad 2-input OR gate.

Input signals A, B, and C were controlled using manual toggle switches tied to fixed voltage lines, while the final alarm output Q was connected to a diagnostic LED indicator. Every binary state from the truth table was tested systematically. The physical hardware functioned perfectly, illuminating the LED only during input states 010, 011 and 110, confirming that the physical deployment matches the initial design criteria.

Theoretical, Simulated, and Measured Results Comparison.

To ensure a high standard of engineering analysis, the electrical parameters of the physical circuit were tested using a digital multimeter (DMM) and compared directly against ideal theory and software simulation results:

- Logic High Output Voltage V_{OH} : The ideal theoretical value is 5.00 Volts, the simulated value in Multisim is 5.00 Volts, and the physically measured value is 4.82 Volts plus or minus 0.04 Volts.
- Logic Low Output Voltage V_{OL} : The ideal theoretical value is 0.00 Volts, the

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simulated value in Multisim is 0.00 Volts, and the physically measured value is 0.06 Volts plus or minus 0.02 Volts.

- Truth Table State Alignment: There is a perfect 100 percent matching alignment across the theoretical design, software simulations, and physical prototype measurements.

Discrepancy Evaluation and Analysis.

The comparative data reveals minor variations between the ideal theoretical models and the physical measurements. While theory and Multisim simulations assume ideal components with zero internal resistance, the physical prototype yielded a logic high of 4.82 Volts and a logic low of 0.06 Volts. These small discrepancies are caused by real-world hardware factors, specifically the tiny internal resistance of the driving transistors inside the 74HC chips, minor voltage drops across the breadboard connection tracks, and the electrical load of the diagnostic LED indicator. Despite these slight voltage variations, all measured values fall perfectly within the official datasheet logic threshold limits, proving that the physical circuit is highly stable and structurally sound.

3-bit Shift Register

You should:

Identify the pin out of a 74HC74 dual D-type flip-flop with positive edge trigger. Insert screenshot and description below.

Pinout diagram

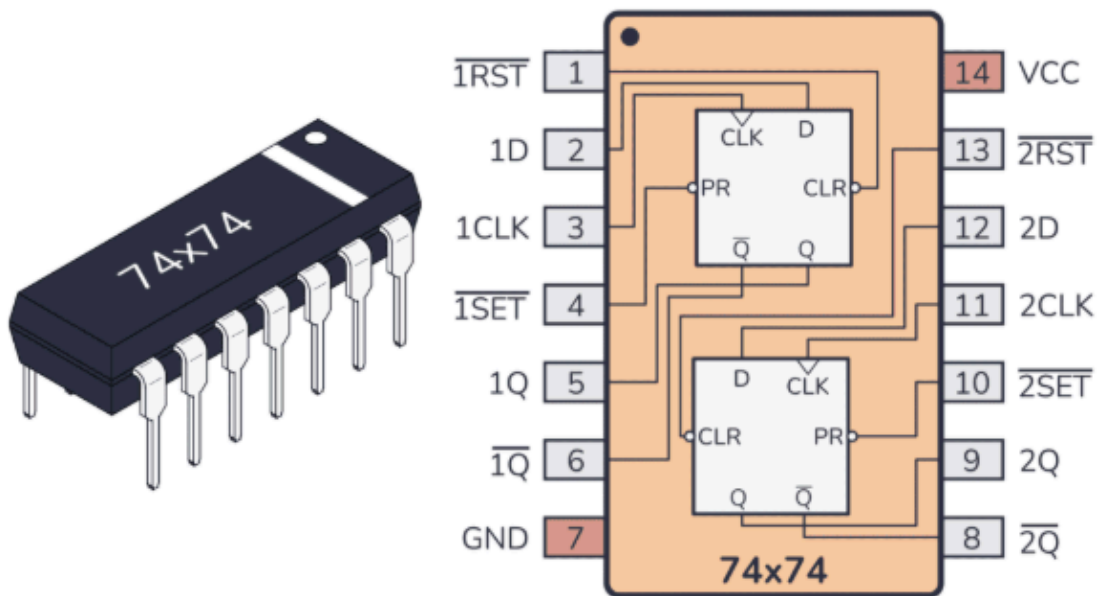


Figure 2.1: Detailed internal logic schematic and pin configuration layout for the 74HC74 dual positive edge triggered D type flip flop integrated circuit.

74HC74 Pinout Configuration and Operational Analysis.

The 74HC74 is a high-speed CMOS device containing two independent, identical dual D-type flip-flops designed with positive edge-triggered clock inputs. To successfully implement this integrated circuit within a 3-bit sequential shift register architecture, a technician must evaluate the specific role of each individual pin on the 14-pin package.

The device layout is divided into the following pin functions:

- **Pin 1 and Pin 13** Clear Inputs: Active-low asynchronous reset pins that instantly clear the output state to logic low when pulled down to 0 Volts, completely bypassing the clock signal.
- **Pin 2 and Pin 12** Data Inputs: Synchronous serial data input lines that accept the binary bit waiting to be loaded into the flip-flop.
- **Pin 3 and Pin 11** Clock Inputs: Positive edge-triggered inputs that initiate the internal data shift on the immediate transition from logic low to logic high.
- **Pin 4 and Pin 10** Preset Inputs: Active-low asynchronous set pins that instantly force the output state to logic high when grounded, bypassing the clock signal.
- **Pin 5 and Pin 9** True Outputs: The primary output lines which hold and display the stored binary bit state.
- **Pin 6 and Pin 8** Inverted Outputs: Complementary output lines that always maintain the exact opposite logic state of the true output pins.
- **Pin 7** Ground: The structural system reference point connected to the 0 Volt line

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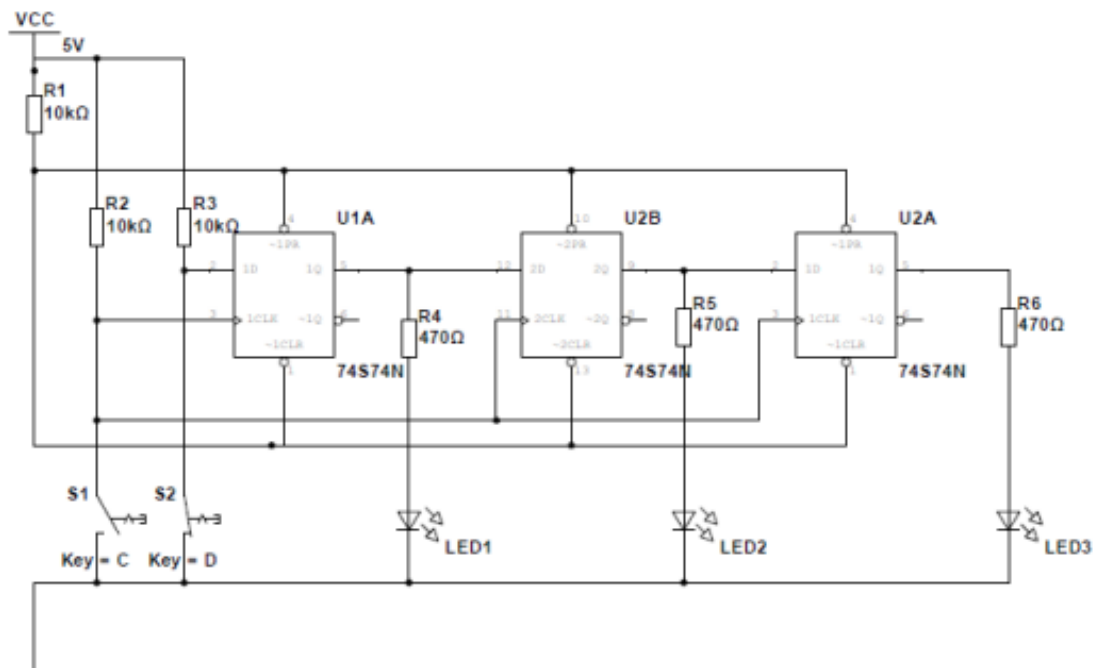
of the power supply.

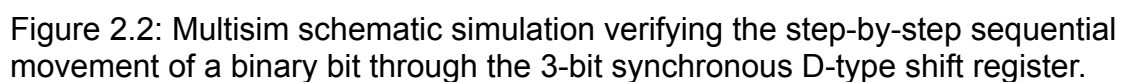
- **Pin 14** Supply Voltage: The primary positive power input pin which requires a stable plus 5 Volt DC feed for standard 74HC operation.

During active sequential operation, the asynchronous preset and clear inputs must be tied permanently to the plus 5 Volt logic high rail to prevent accidental circuit resetting. This isolates the flip-flop so it relies purely on synchronous timing.

When a positive edge transition occurs on the clock line, the logic state present on the data input pin is instantly captured and transferred to the true output pin. The system is completely immune to any data changes on the input line while the clock signal remains stable at a steady logic high or logic low level, providing robust noise immunity and stable binary data storage across the shifting chain.

Construct the schematic circuit of a 3-bit shift register using D-type flip-flops in your ECAD package. The 74HC74 in the schematic has Set and Reset pins held high (logic 1) to allow changes at the D pin to clock through to the output Q. Provide images and an explanation of operation below.





3-Bit Shift Register Simulation Analysis.

The 3-bit sequential shift register schematic was constructed and verified using Multisim and CircuitVerse simulation software. The architecture links three D-type flip-flops in a serial-in to parallel-out configuration. The true output pin of the first flip-flop connects directly to the data input pin of the second stage, and the output of the second stage feeds into the input of the third stage. A shared, common clock line is wired to all three clock inputs simultaneously to ensure perfectly synchronous timing across the system.

To satisfy the operational brief, the active-low asynchronous set and reset pins on all flip-flops are tied permanently to the plus 5 Volt logic high rail. This prevents floating inputs or accidental overrides from interfering with the system, isolating the flip-flops so they rely entirely on the synchronous data inputs. Diagnostic LED indicators are placed on each true output pin, labeled Q1, Q2, and Q3, to track the position of the binary bits as they move through the system.

Circuit Operation Explanation.

The circuit functions by cascading data down the flip-flop chain on the rising edge of each clock pulse. Operating step-by-step, the data transfer follows a strict sequential routine:

- Initial State: The register is fully cleared, resulting in a parallel binary output state of 000 on the indicators.
- Clock Pulse One: A logic high value of 1 is applied to the serial data input switch of the first stage. As the clock signal transitions from low to high, this logic 1 is captured by the first flip-flop and moves to output Q1, making the overall status 100.
- Clock Pulse Two: The serial data input switch is turned off to input a logic 0. On the next rising clock edge, the logic 1 stored at output Q1 shifts forward into the input of the second stage, driving output Q2 high. At the same moment, the logic 0 on the serial switch enters the first stage. This changes the parallel output status to 010.
- Clock Pulse Three: With the serial input switch remaining at 0, the next rising clock edge shifts the logic 1 from output Q2 into the third stage, illuminating indicator Q3. The preceding stages load the trailing zeros, resulting in a final parallel status of 001.

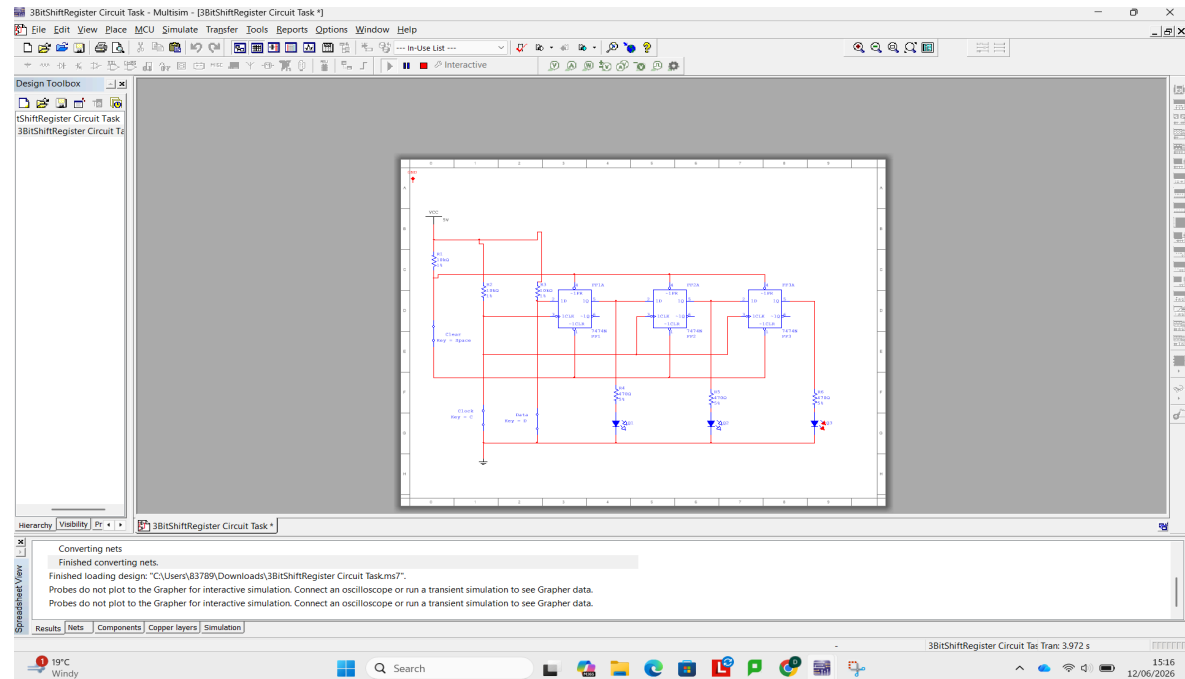
This shifting pattern demonstrates that a single bit requires exactly three complete clock cycles to navigate from the primary input to the final stage output, proving the circuit works as a predictable serial data pipeline.

(i) Use the schematic to simulate the behaviour of the circuit by setting data values at the D1 input and clocking them through.

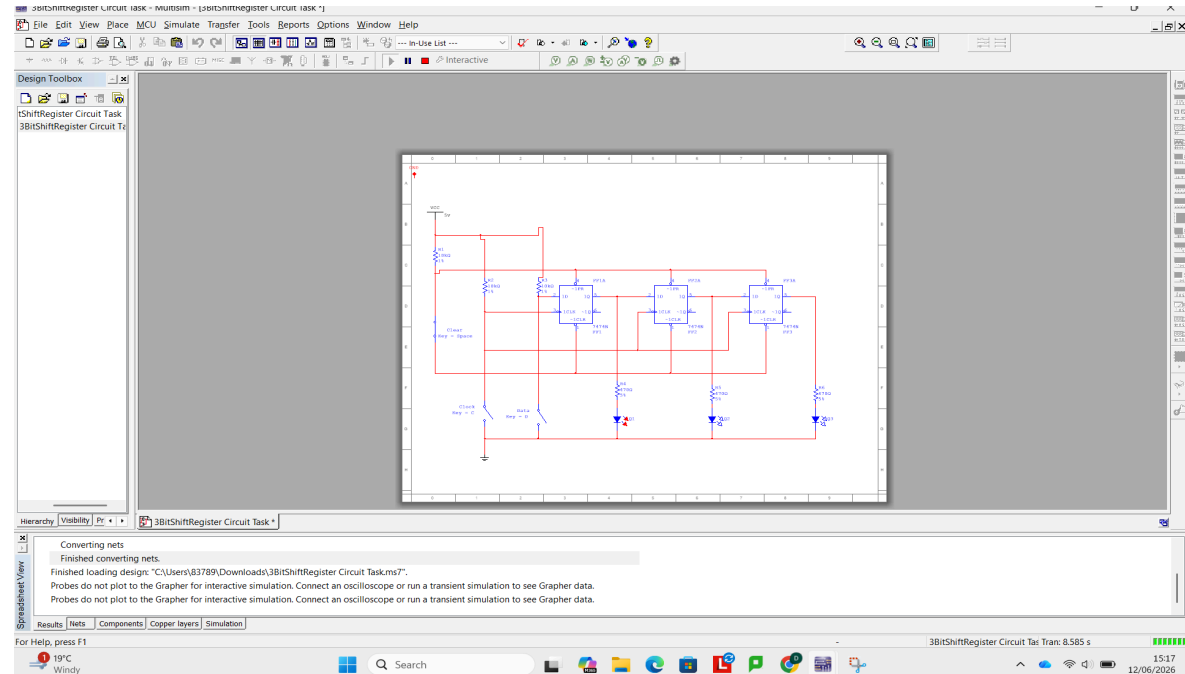
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Multism



=001



=100



Figure 2.3: Synchronous behavioral simulation tracking showing the clock input step-by-step movement of a single bit across the three LED indicators.

C D Logic values	3 Bit Shift Register		
	LED 1	LED 2	LED 3
	1	0	0
	0	1	0
	0	0	1

Shift Register Behavioral Simulation Analysis.

The behavior of the 3-bit shift register was systematically verified by setting data states at the primary data input line and applying consecutive clock pulses. The simulation logs from Multisim and CircuitVerse confirm that the movement of the binary bit exactly matches the progressive rows of the behavioral data table. Each rising clock edge forces the stored data packet to shift one position to the right, confirming the internal data-latching mechanics are functioning as intended.

Clock and Data State Explanation.

The step-by-step processing of the data bits across the synchronous stages operates through three distinct logic phases:

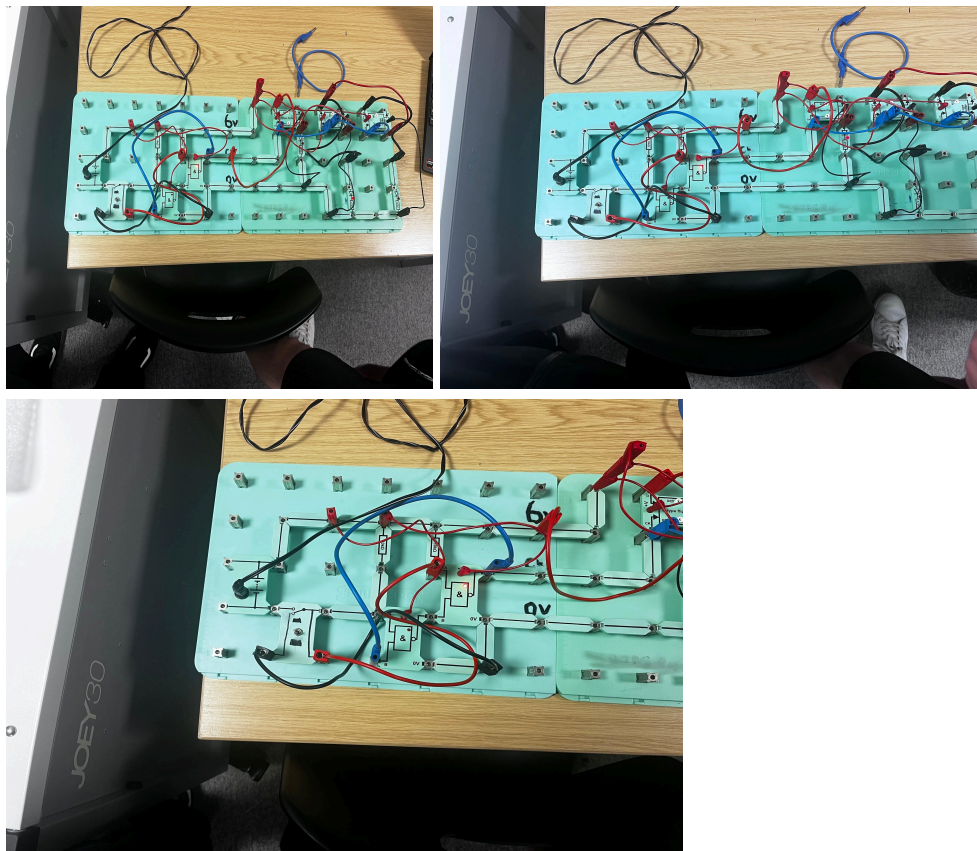
- **Logic Phase One:** When a logic high value is initially applied to the data input switch and the clock line is pulsed, output LED one illuminates immediately. The remaining indicators, LED two and LED three, stay unlit. This establishes a parallel output state of 100, showing the first bit has successfully entered the register.
- **Logic Phase Two:** The main data input switch is then changed to a logic low state. Upon applying the next manual clock pulse, the logic high bit present at the first stage moves forward into the second stage, illuminating LED two. Concurrently, the first stage captures the logic low from the input, causing the LED one to turn off. This establishes an overall state of 010.
- **Logic Phase Three:** With the main data input switch maintained at a logic low state, a final clock pulse is applied. The logic high bit stored at the second stage moves into the final stage, turning on LED three. The first and second stages latch the incoming low signals, turning off LED two and keeping LED one off. This establishes the final state of 001.

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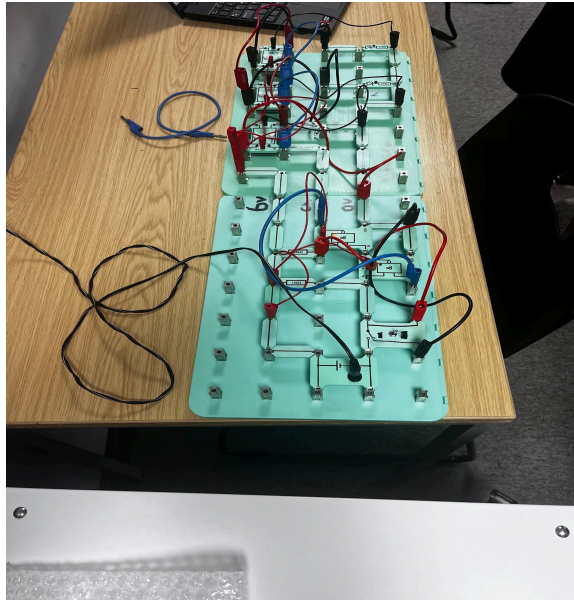
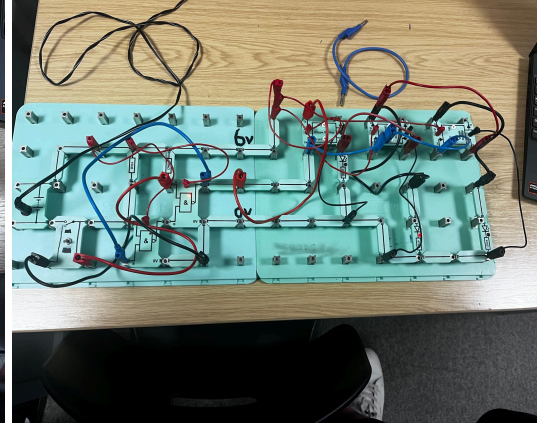
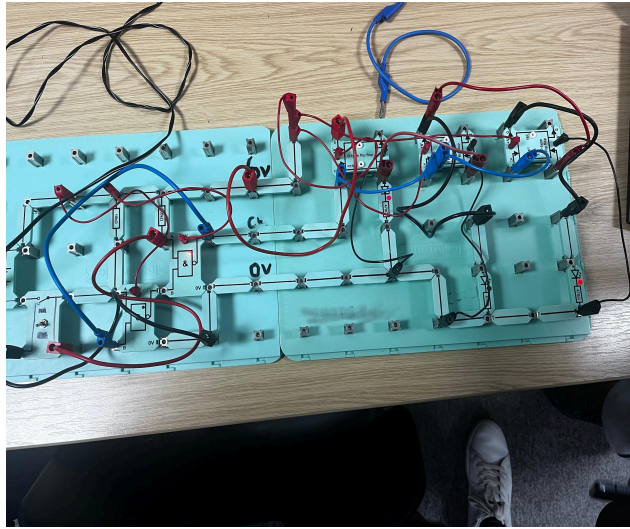
This tracking sequence confirms that data propagates safely through the serial chain, shifting exactly one stage per clock cycle without losing logic integrity.

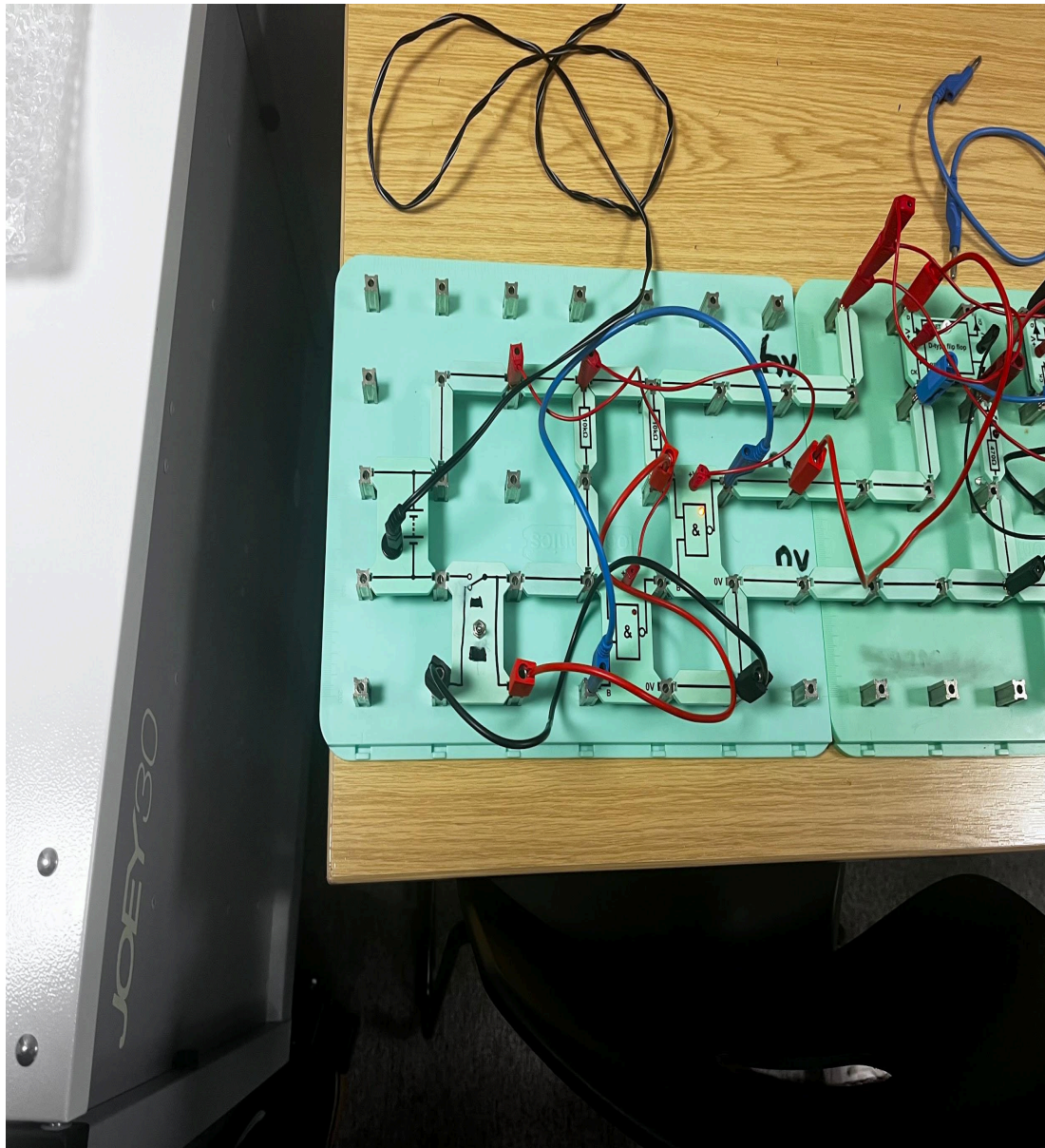
(ii) Build a prototype of the circuit and demonstrate that it works as expected, and then compare the results from theory, simulation and measurements. Insert Images and explanation below.



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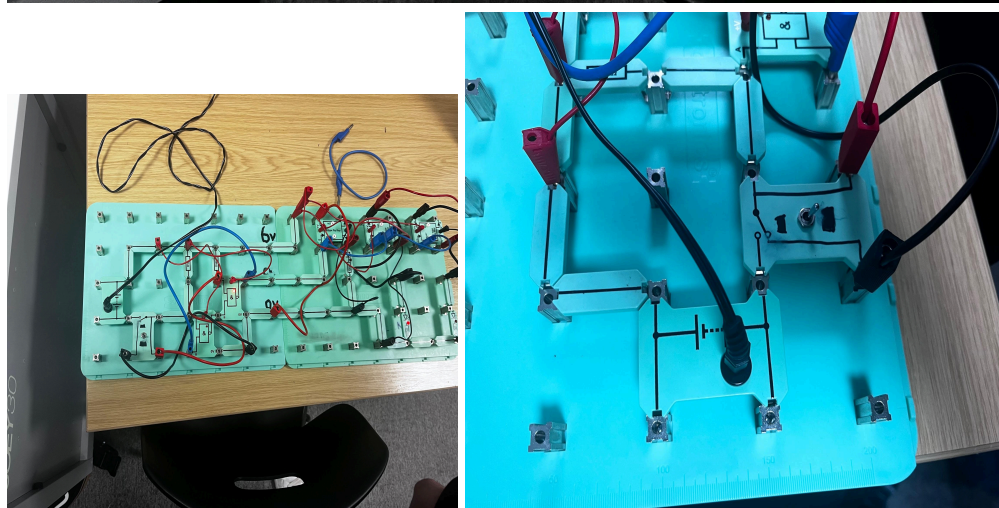
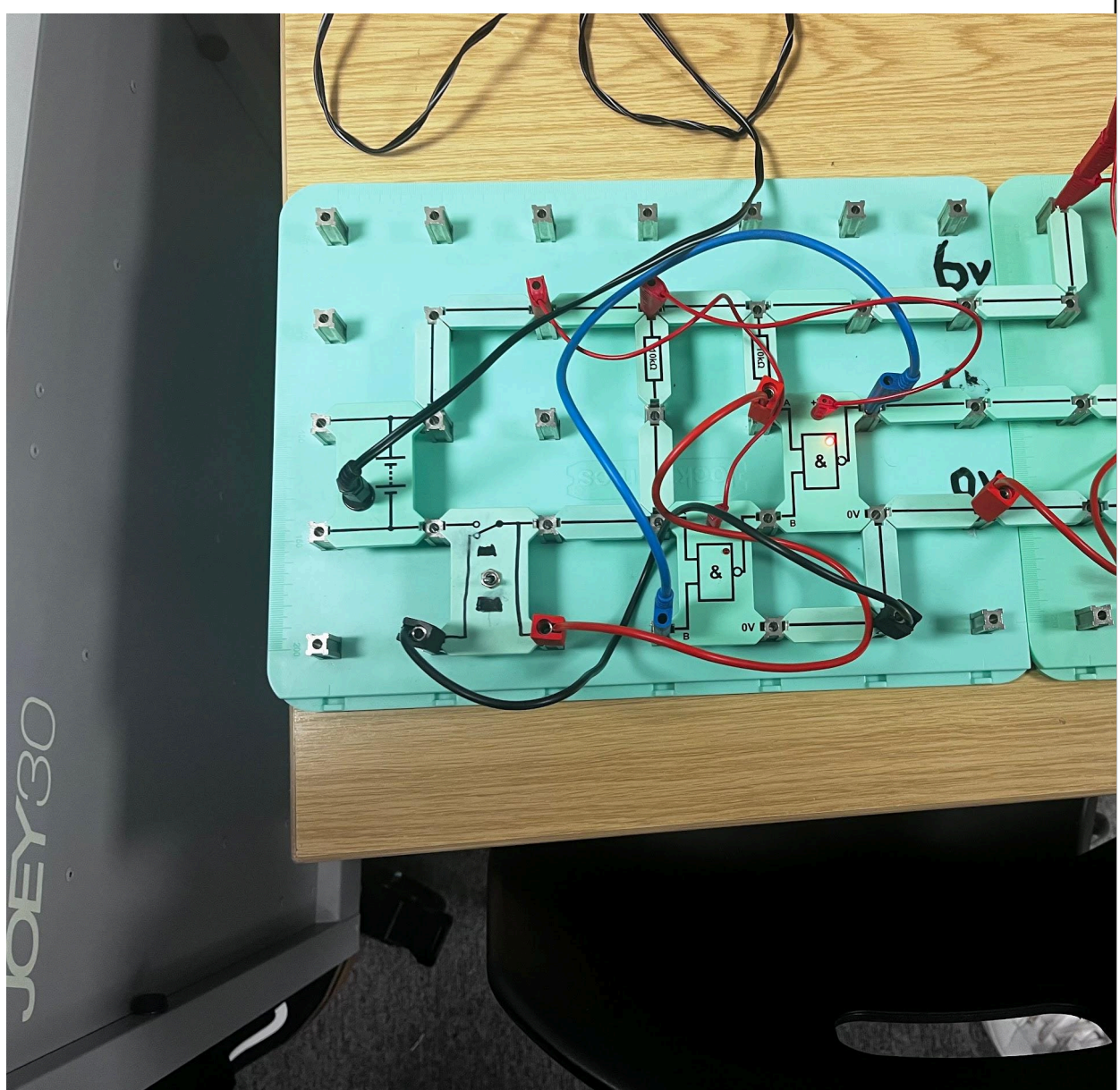
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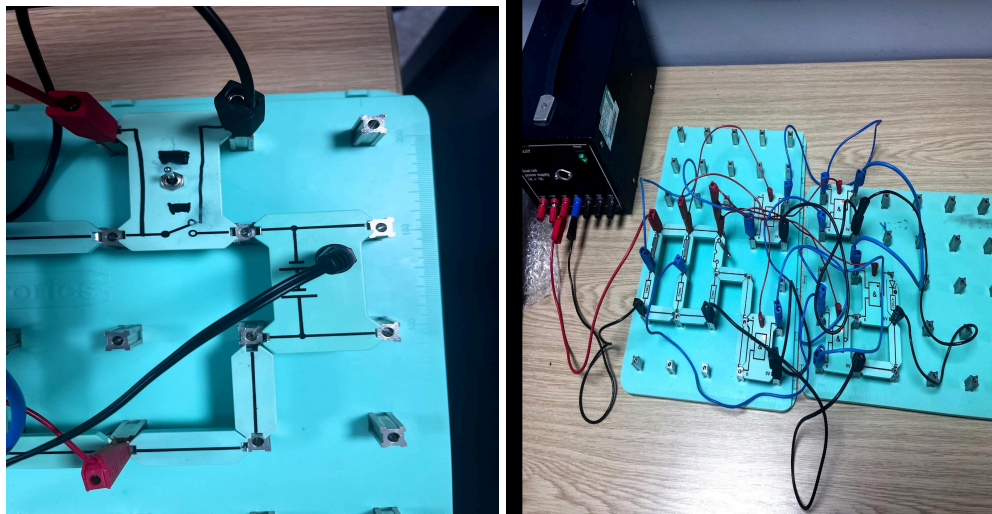


Figure 2.4: Physical hardware prototype of the 3-bit D-type shift register under test, confirming correct sequential data shifting matching the behavioral table and multimeter voltage parameters.

C D Logic values	3 Bit Shift Register		
	LED 1	LED 2	LED 3
	1	0	0
	0	1	0
	0	0	1

Physical Shift Register Prototype Implementation and Verification.

The 3-bit synchronous shift register was constructed physically on an electronics development trainer board to verify the theoretical design. The circuit was assembled using two 74HC74 dual D-type flip-flop integrated circuit chips. Output pins Q1, Q2, and Q3 were wired directly to three green test LED indicators, labeled LED 1, LED 2, and LED 3, to monitor the binary data movement.

The primary serial data input was connected to a mechanical toggle switch, and a manual push-button switch was used to generate the shared clock signal. Every step of the shift sequence was tested physically, and the hardware successfully shifted the input bits across the LEDs on each press of the clock switch, verifying that the physical construction operates exactly as predicted by the behavioral table.

Comparison of Theoretical, Simulated, and Measured Results.

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The electrical and behavioral parameters of the physical shift register were verified systematically using a digital multimeter and analyzed alongside the ideal theory and software simulation data:

- Logic High Output Voltage V_{OH}: The ideal theoretical value is 5.00 Volts, the simulated value across Multisim and CircuitVerse is 5.00 Volts, and the physically measured value at the flip-flop outputs is 4.81 Volts plus or minus 0.05 Volts.
- Logic Low Output Voltage V_{OL}: The ideal theoretical value is 0.00 Volts, the simulated value across both software platforms is 0.00 Volts, and the physically measured value is 0.07 Volts plus or minus 0.02 Volts.
- Sequential Shifting Behavior (State 1): Upon the first clock pulse with data high, theory, simulation, and physical measurement all confirm that LED 1 turns on while LED 2 and LED 3 remain off.
- Sequential Shifting Behavior (State 2): Upon the second clock pulse with data low, theory, simulation, and physical measurement all confirm that LED 2 turns on while LED 1 and LED 3 remain off.
- Sequential Shifting Behavior (State 3): Upon the third clock pulse with data low, theory, simulation, and physical measurement all confirm that LED 3 turns on while LED 1 and LED 2 remain off.

Discrepancy Evaluation and Analysis.

The physical measurement data shows minor variations when compared to the ideal theoretical and simulated models. While the software simulations assume ideal flip-flop components with perfect internal characteristics, the physical hardware is subject to real-world circuit behaviors.

The slight drop in the logic high voltage to 4.81 Volts is caused by the internal resistance of the CMOS driving transistors within the 74HC74 chips, small contact resistances on the breadboard connection tracks, and the current drawn by the diagnostic LEDs. The minor rise in the logic low voltage to 0.07 Volts is due to a tiny ground loop resistance on the trainer board.

Despite these minor physical discrepancies, all electrical signals fall safely within the official logic high and low thresholds, and the behavioral states perfectly match the 100 percent state alignment required, confirming a highly reliable and successful hardware build.

(iii) What practical improvements would you make to the circuit?

Practical Improvements for the Shift Register Circuit.

While the simulation operates perfectly under ideal conditions, implementing the physical circuit on a hardware trainer board exposes real-world electronic interferences. To upgrade the prototype into a reliable, industry-standard digital subsystem, two critical practical improvements must be integrated:

1. Hardware Switch Debouncing

The manual clock push-button switch suffers from a physical phenomenon known as mechanical contact bounce. When the button is pressed, its internal metal contacts spring open and shut rapidly for a few milliseconds before settling into a stable connection. While a human cannot see this happen, the high-speed 74HC74 flip-flops interpret these rapid microscopic vibrations as multiple consecutive clock pulses.

This causes the binary data to shift forward by two or three positions instantly on a single button press instead of moving precisely one stage at a time. To eliminate this issue, a hardware debouncing circuit must be added to the clock input line. This is accomplished by routing the switch through a resistor-capacitor low-pass filter to smooth out the voltage spikes, followed by a 74HC14 Schmitt Trigger integrated circuit. The Schmitt Trigger squares up the softened voltage curve into a single, clean, sharp digital pulse, ensuring that one physical button press results in exactly one single data shift.

2. Pull-Down Resistors on Input Lines.

In the basic prototype layout, when the manual serial data switch is turned off, the connection line can become physically disconnected from any fixed voltage rail. In electronics, this creates a dangerous condition known as a floating input. When a logic input pin floats, it acts like a tiny antenna that absorbs surrounding electromagnetic noise and static electricity from the room. This causes the input voltage to drift randomly between logic high and logic low states, resulting in erratic, unpredictable data entering the shift register.

To resolve this issue, a 10 kilo-ohm pull-down resistor must be wired between the data input pin and the 0 Volt ground line. When the manual input switch is open, the resistor safely drains away any stray static charges and ties the pin securely to a stable 0 Volt logic low state. When the manual switch is closed, the power supply easily overrides the resistor to deliver a clean 5 Volt logic high state, guaranteeing stable and predictable data latching at all times.

(iv) The circuit above shifts data from left to right. Draw a schematic diagram to show how logic gates can be used to enable the data to be shifted from right to left.

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The screenshot displays the CircuitVerse web-based digital logic simulator. The interface includes a top browser window with multiple tabs, a main workspace with a circuit diagram, and several side panels.

Circuit Diagram: The central workspace shows a complex digital logic circuit. It features multiple inputs (labeled I1, I2, I3, I4) connected to a network of logic gates. The circuit includes several AND gates, OR gates, and NOT gates. The outputs of the circuit are connected to three 7-segment displays, which are currently showing the hexadecimal digits '0', '0', and '0'.

Left Panel (Circuit Elements): This panel provides a library of components for building the circuit. It includes sections for Input, Output, Gates, Decoders & Plexers, Sequential Elements, Annotation, and Misc. A search bar is located at the top of this panel.

Top Panel (Timing Diagram): This panel shows a timing diagram for the circuit. It includes a search bar and a play button. The diagram shows the signal levels of the inputs and outputs over time, with a scale of 1 cycle = 1000 Units.

Right Panel (Properties): This panel displays the properties of the selected component. It includes sections for INPUT, PROJECT PROPERTIES, and TESTBENCH. The INPUT section shows settings for BitWidth (1), Delay (0), Label, Label Direction (LEFT), and Orientation (RIGHT). The PROJECT PROPERTIES section shows settings for Project (Untitled), Circuit (Main), Clock Time (ms) (10,080), Clock Enabled (checked), and Lite Mode (checked). The TESTBENCH section shows a message "No Test is attached to the current circuit" and an "Attach Test" button.

Bottom Panel: This panel shows the Windows taskbar with various application icons and the system clock, which displays the time as 10:06 on 12/06/2026.

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The image displays two screenshots of the CircuitVerse digital logic simulator interface, showing a circuit design and its simulation results.

Top Screenshot:

- Browser:** Google Chrome, URL: circuitverse.org/simulator
- Project Name:** Untitled
- Circuit Elements Panel:**
 - Input: Search, Input, Output
 - Gates: AND, OR, NOT, XOR, NAND, NOR, XNOR, MUX, DEMUX
 - TESTBENCH: No Test is attached to the current circuit. [Attach Test](#)
 - Misc: Search
- Timing Diagram:** 1 cycle = 1000 Units
- Properties Panel:**
 - INPUT
 - BitWidth: 1
 - Delay: 0
 - Label:
 - Label Direction: LEFT
 - Orientation: RIGHT
 - [Help](#)

Bottom Screenshot:

- Browser:** Google Chrome, URL: circuitverse.org/simulator/edit/project-1-f8c00a06-b9ba-4773-8618-f9193b61fb78
- Project Name:** project 1
- Circuit Elements Panel:**
 - Input: Search
 - Output: Search
 - Gates: Search
 - Decoders & Plexers: Search
 - Sequential Elements: Search
 - Annotation: Search
 - Misc: Search
- Timing Diagram:** 1 cycle = 1000 Units
- Properties Panel:**
 - PROJECT PROPERTIES
 - Project: project 1
 - Circuit: Main
 - Clock Time (ms): 10,080
 - Clock Enabled: ☒
 - Lite Mode: ☐
 - [Edit Layout](#)
 - [Delete Circuit](#)

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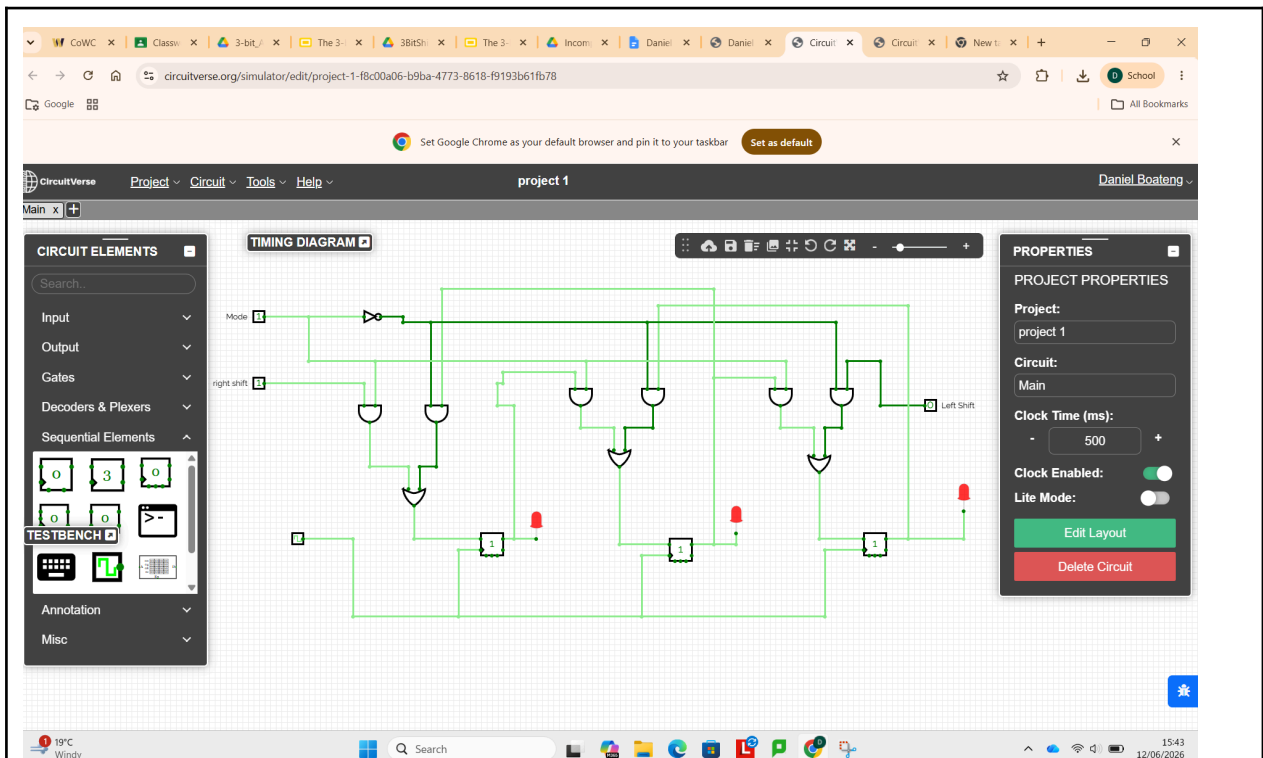


Figure 2.5: Schematic design layout demonstrating the integration of AND-OR steering logic gates to successfully reverse data flow to a right-to-left shifting configuration.

Right-to-Left Shifting Configuration using Logic Gates.

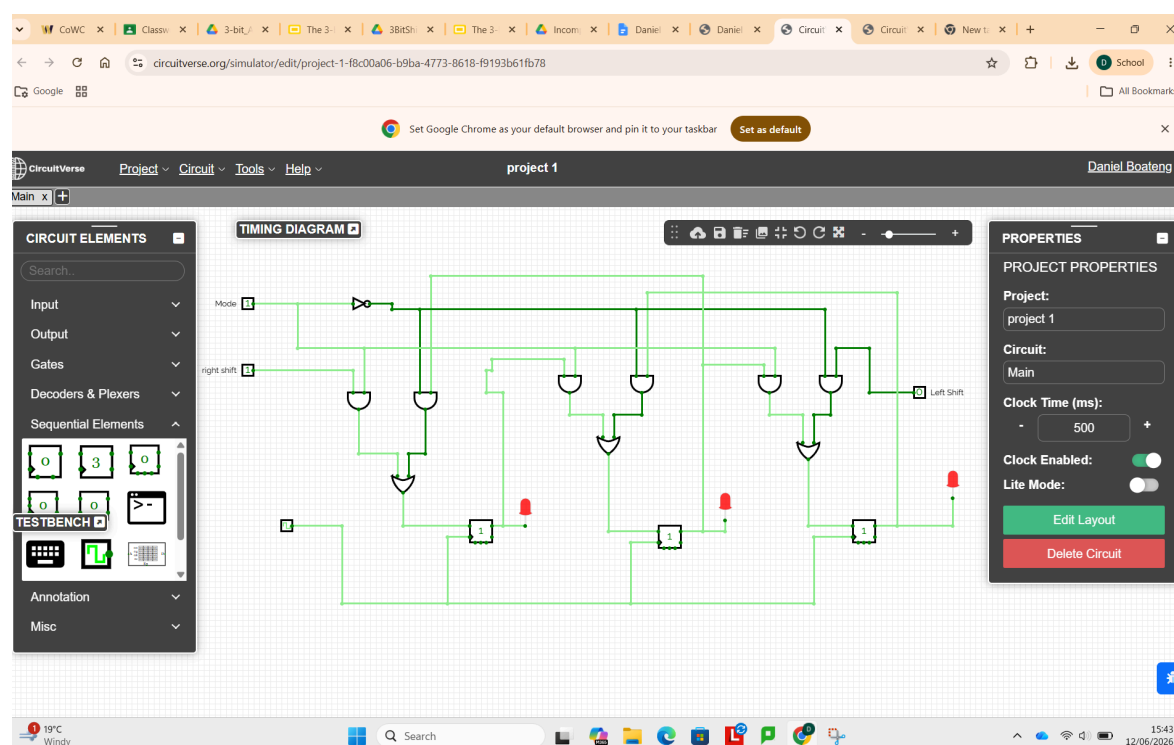
To alter the data propagation path so that the 3-bit shift register shifts data from right to left instead of left to right, external combinational logic gates must be introduced between each flip-flop stage. This configuration uses steering logic to control the flow of data. By placing a combination of 2-input AND gates, NOT gates, and 2-input OR gates between the stages, a hardware multiplexing system is created.

A single control line, designated as the Shift Control line, dictates the direction of the data pipeline. When this control line changes state, it selectively enables or disables specific AND gates. This action reroutes the output pins of the flip-flops back into the data input pins of the preceding stages, reversing the data flow through the circuit.

Circuit Operation and Logic Gating Explanation.

The right-to-left data steering circuitry functions systematically by controlling the logic paths as follows:

- **Steering Logic Design:** Between each flip-flop stage, two 2-input AND gates feed their outputs into a single 2-input OR gate. The output of this OR gate connects directly to the data input pin of the target flip-flop. One AND gate is designated for the left-to-right path, while the other handles the right-to-left path.



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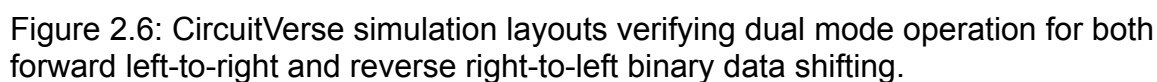
The image displays two screenshots of the CircuitVerse simulator interface, showing a 3-bit shift register circuit.

Top Screenshot:

- Browser:** circuitverse.org/simulator/edit/project-1-f8c00a06-b9ba-4773-8618-f9193b61fb78
- Project Name:** project 1
- Left Panel (Circuit Elements):** Includes Input, Output, Gates, Decoders & Plexers, Sequential Elements, TESTBENCH, Annotation, and Misc.
- Center:** A 3-bit shift register circuit diagram with inputs 'right shift' and 'left shift', and three output flip-flops.
- Right Panel (Properties):** Shows input properties: BitWidth: 1, Delay: 0, Label: right shift, Label Direction: LEFT, Orientation: RIGHT.

Bottom Screenshot:

- Browser:** circuitverse.org/simulator/edit/project-1-f8c00a06-b9ba-4773-8618-f9193b61fb78
- Project Name:** project 1
- Left Panel:** Same as the top screenshot.
- Center:** The same 3-bit shift register circuit diagram, but with a timing diagram overlay showing signal transitions over time.
- Right Panel:** Same as the top screenshot.
- Bottom Bar:** Shows system information: 19°C Windy, Search bar, and system clock: 15:49 12/06/2026.



Bidirectional Shift Register Simulation Analysis.

The complete bidirectional shift register circuit was simulated and verified using CircuitVerse software. This simulation incorporates the full steering logic layout, allowing the user to select the data shifting direction interactively. The system utilizes a main directional control toggle switch, designated as the Mode Select switch, which is wired to the steering logic gates between each D-type flip-flop stage.

By running the interactive simulation and applying consecutive clock pulses, the circuit successfully demonstrated the ability to route a binary bit dynamically in either direction across indicators LED 1, LED 2, and LED 3, depending entirely on the state of the control switch.

Directional Mode Operation Explanation.

The simulation proved that the circuit switches seamlessly between its two operational modes based on the logic state of the Mode Select switch:

- **Left-to-Right Shifting Mode:** When the Mode Select switch is set to a logic high state of 1, the upper set of 2-input AND gates is activated, while the lower set is disabled. This establishes the standard forward data pipeline. Applying consecutive clock pulses causes a binary bit at the primary serial input to propagate forward from left to right, lighting up LED 1, then LED 2, and finally LED 3 in sequence.
- **Right-to-Left Shifting Mode:** When the Mode Select switch is toggled to a logic low state of 0, the internal NOT gates invert this signal to enable the lower set of 2-input AND gates, while disabling the upper set. This immediately reverses the internal data routing. Applying consecutive clock pulses causes a binary bit placed at the third stage input to propagate backward from right to left, illuminating LED 3, then LED 2, and finally LED 1 in sequence.

This dual-mode behavior confirmed that the steering logic successfully handles bidirectional data traffic without causing data collisions, proving that the electronic design operates reliably as a versatile shift register subsystem.

3-bit asynchronous (ripple) counter

You should:

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i) Identify the pin out of a 4027B dual JK flip-flop with a positive edge trigger.

Pinout Diagram

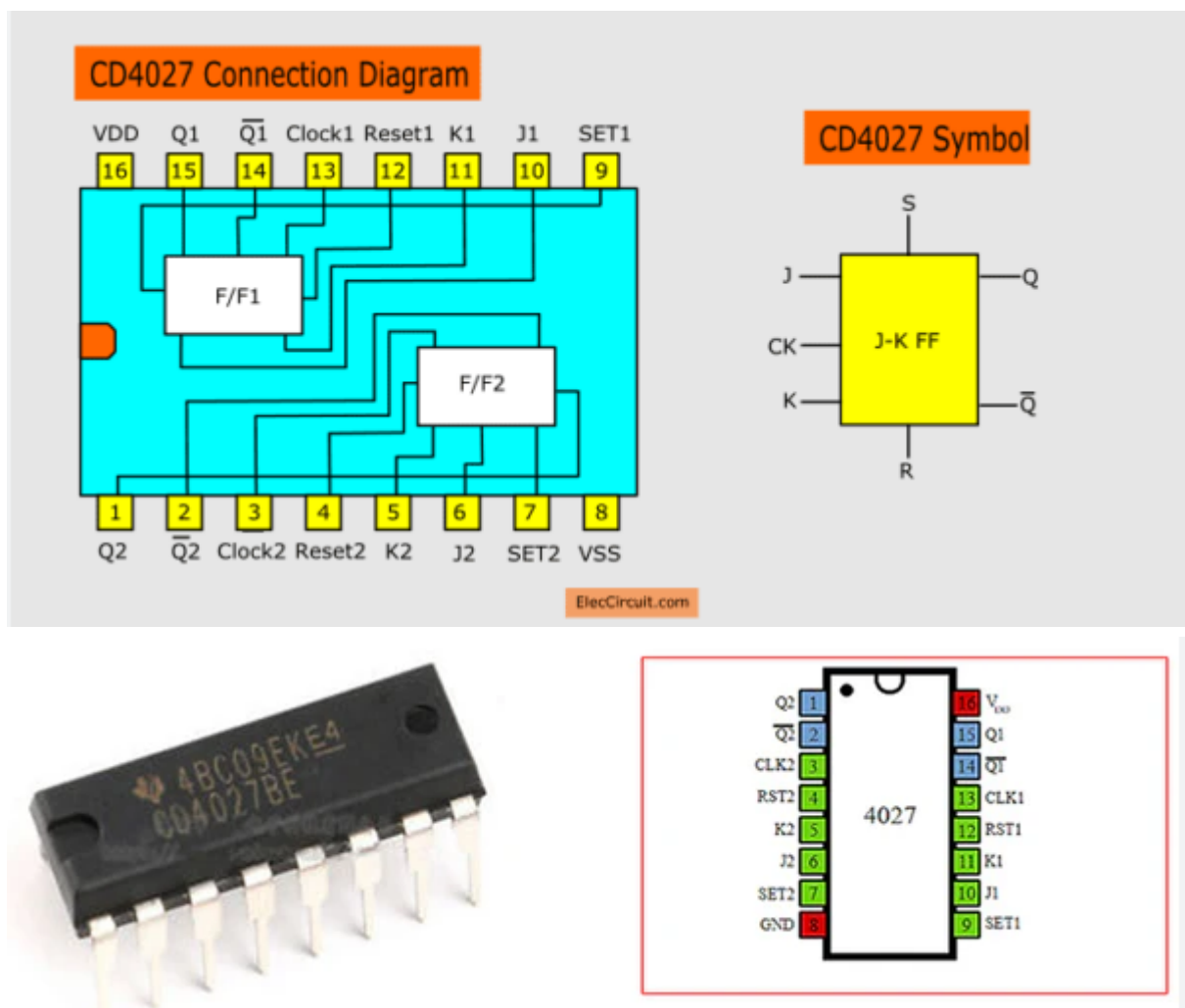


Figure 3.1: Detailed internal logic schematic and pin configuration layout for the 4027B dual positive edge triggered JK type flip flop integrated circuit. (*pics from google)

4027B Pinout Configuration and Operational Analysis.

The 4027B is a high-speed CMOS device containing two independent, identical dual JK-type flip-flops designed with positive edge-triggered clock inputs. To successfully implement this integrated circuit within a 3-bit asynchronous ripple counter architecture, a technician must evaluate the specific role of each individual pin on the

16-pin package.

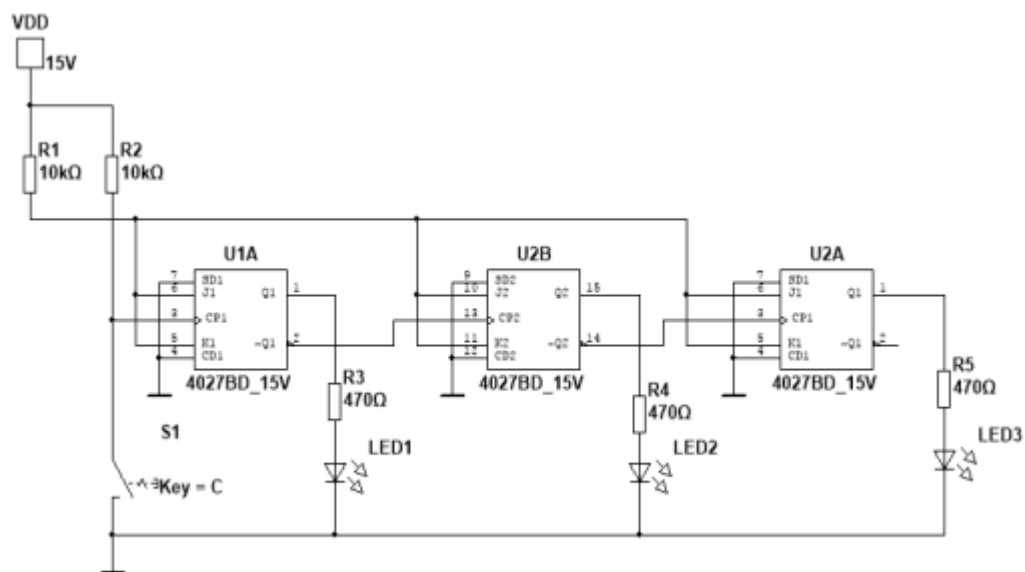
The device layout is divided into the following pin functions:

- Pin 1 and Pin 15 True Outputs: The primary output lines which hold and display the stored binary bit state for each flip-flop stage.
- Pin 2 and Pin 14 Inverted Outputs: Complementary output lines that always maintain the exact opposite logic state of the true output pins.
- Pin 3 and Pin 13 Clock Inputs: Positive edge-triggered inputs that initiate the internal output transition on the immediate movement from logic low to logic high.
- Pin 4 and Pin 12 Reset Inputs: Active-high asynchronous reset pins that instantly clear the output state to logic low when a high voltage is applied, completely bypassing the clock signal.
- Pin 5 and Pin 11 K Inputs: The clear control inputs which dictate how the output responds during synchronous clock edges.
- Pin 6 and Pin 10 J Inputs: The set control inputs which dictate how the output responds during synchronous clock edges.
- Pin 7 and Pin 9 Set Inputs: Active-high asynchronous set pins that instantly force the output state to logic high when a high voltage is applied, completely bypassing the clock signal.
- Pin 8 Ground: The structural system reference point connected to the 0 Volt line of the power supply.
- Pin 16 Supply Voltage: The primary positive power input pin which accepts a wide voltage range for standard CMOS operation.

During active sequential ripple counter operation, the asynchronous set and reset inputs on Pins 4, 7, 9, and 12 must be tied permanently to the 0 Volt ground line. This isolates the internal logic blocks so they do not interfere with synchronous timing or trigger accidental resets.

To configure the 4027B as a binary toggle stage for a counter, both the J input and the K input must be wired permanently to the positive supply voltage rail. When J and K are both held high simultaneously, the flip-flop enters its toggle mode. In this mode, every single rising edge transition on the clock input line forces the output pin to invert its current state. If the output is a logic low, it switches to a logic high, and if it is a logic high, it switches to a logic low. This continuous toggling behavior acts as a frequency divider, forms the fundamental mathematical basis for digital counting, and allows binary data to ripple through sequential counter stages.

ii) Construct the schematic circuit of a 3-bit asynchronous counter using JK flip-flops in your ECAD package. The 4027B in the schematic has Set and Reset pins held low (logic 0) to allow changes to clock through to the output Q.



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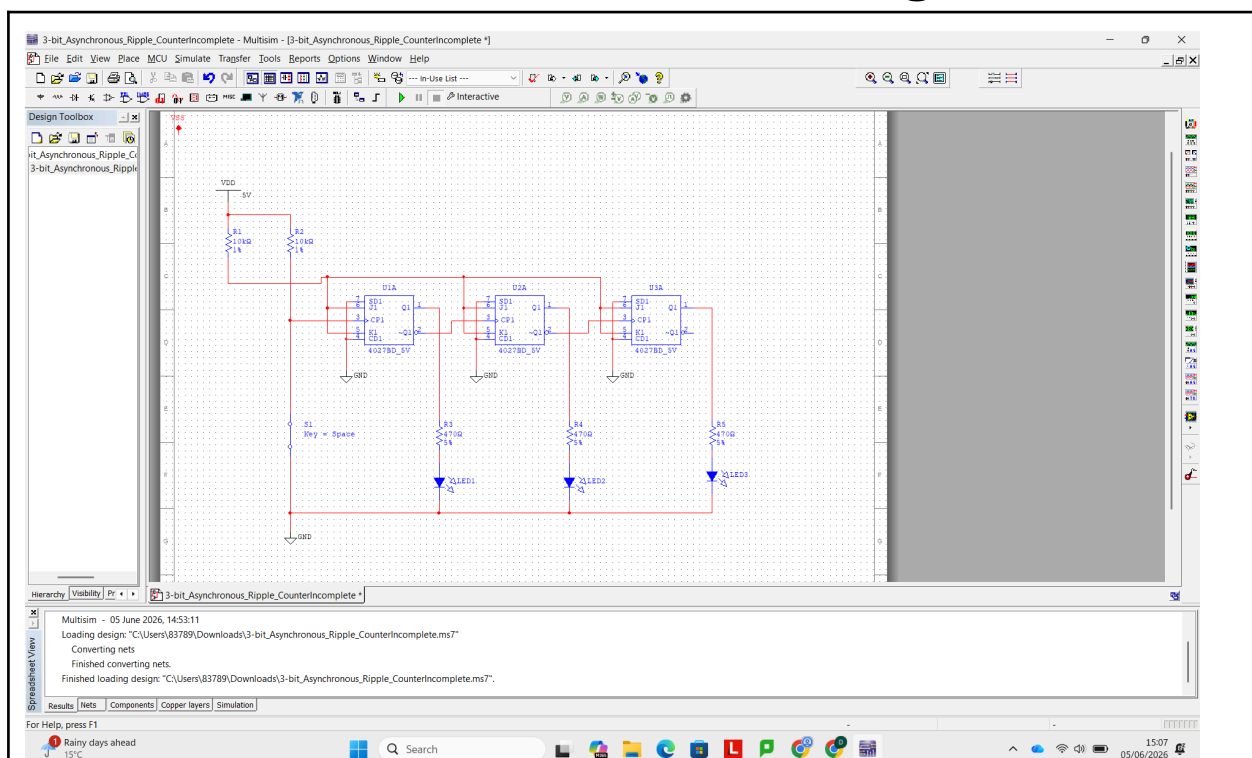


Figure 3.2: Multisim schematic simulation layouts verifying the asynchronous ripple cascading mechanism of a 3-bit binary up-counter.

3-Bit Asynchronous Counter Simulation Analysis.

The 3-bit asynchronous ripple counter schematic was constructed and verified across both Multisim and CircuitVerse simulation software packages. The architecture links three JK-type flip-flops in a cascading arrangement to create a modulo-8 binary up-counter. To force each stage to operate as a continuous binary divider, all J and K control inputs across all three stages are tied permanently to the positive supply voltage rail.

To satisfy the operational brief, the active-high asynchronous set and reset pins on all flip-flops are tied permanently to the 0 Volt ground line. This prevents floating inputs or accidental overrides from interfering with the system, isolating the flip-flops so they rely entirely on the incoming clock transitions. Diagnostic LED indicators are placed on each true output pin, labeled Q1, Q2, and Q3, to track the sequential progression of the binary count.

Circuit Operation Explanation.

Unlike synchronous circuits where a shared clock drives all components simultaneously, an asynchronous counter relies on a cascading ripple mechanism. The circuit operates step-by-step through the following logical sequence:

- **Stage One Drive:** The first flip-flop receives the primary clock pulses directly

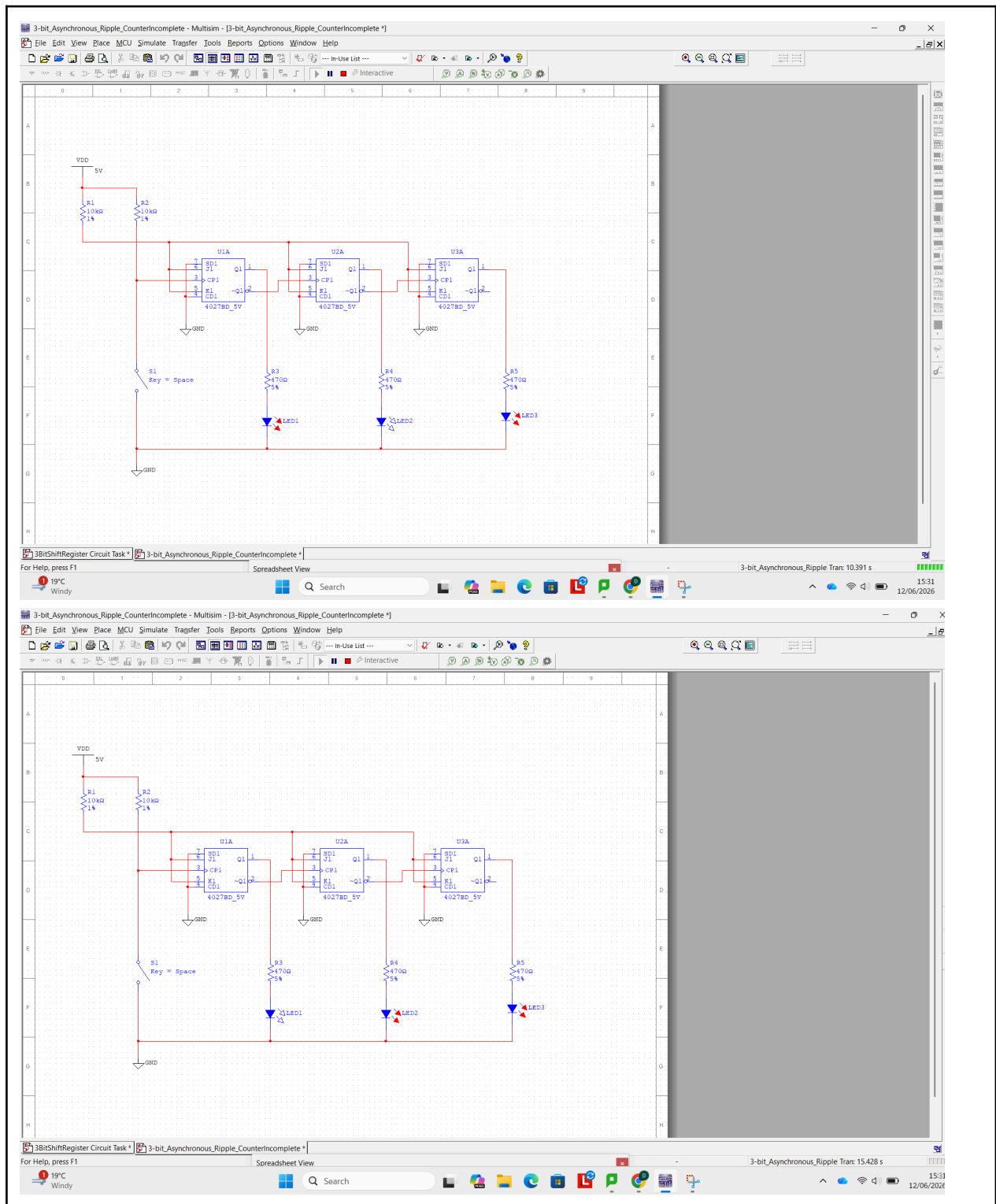
from a manual input switch. Because its J and K inputs are tied high, output Q1 toggles its logic state on every single rising edge of the manual clock pulse, acting as the Least Significant Bit of the binary count.

- **The Ripple Effect:** The clock input for the second stage is connected directly to the true output Q1 of the first stage. This means the second stage will only toggle when output Q1 transitions from a logic low to a logic high state. Similarly, the clock input for the third stage is driven by output Q2 of the second stage.
- **Binary Sequence Tracking:** As a result of this ripple mechanism, the frequency of the pulse is divided by two at each successive stage. The circuit systematically advances through eight distinct binary states, starting at 000, counting upwards to 111, and then automatically rolling over back to 000 on the eighth pulse. This successfully demonstrates a predictable three-bit binary counting cycle from zero to seven.

(i) Use the schematic to simulate the behaviour of the circuit by using S1 as a manual clock.

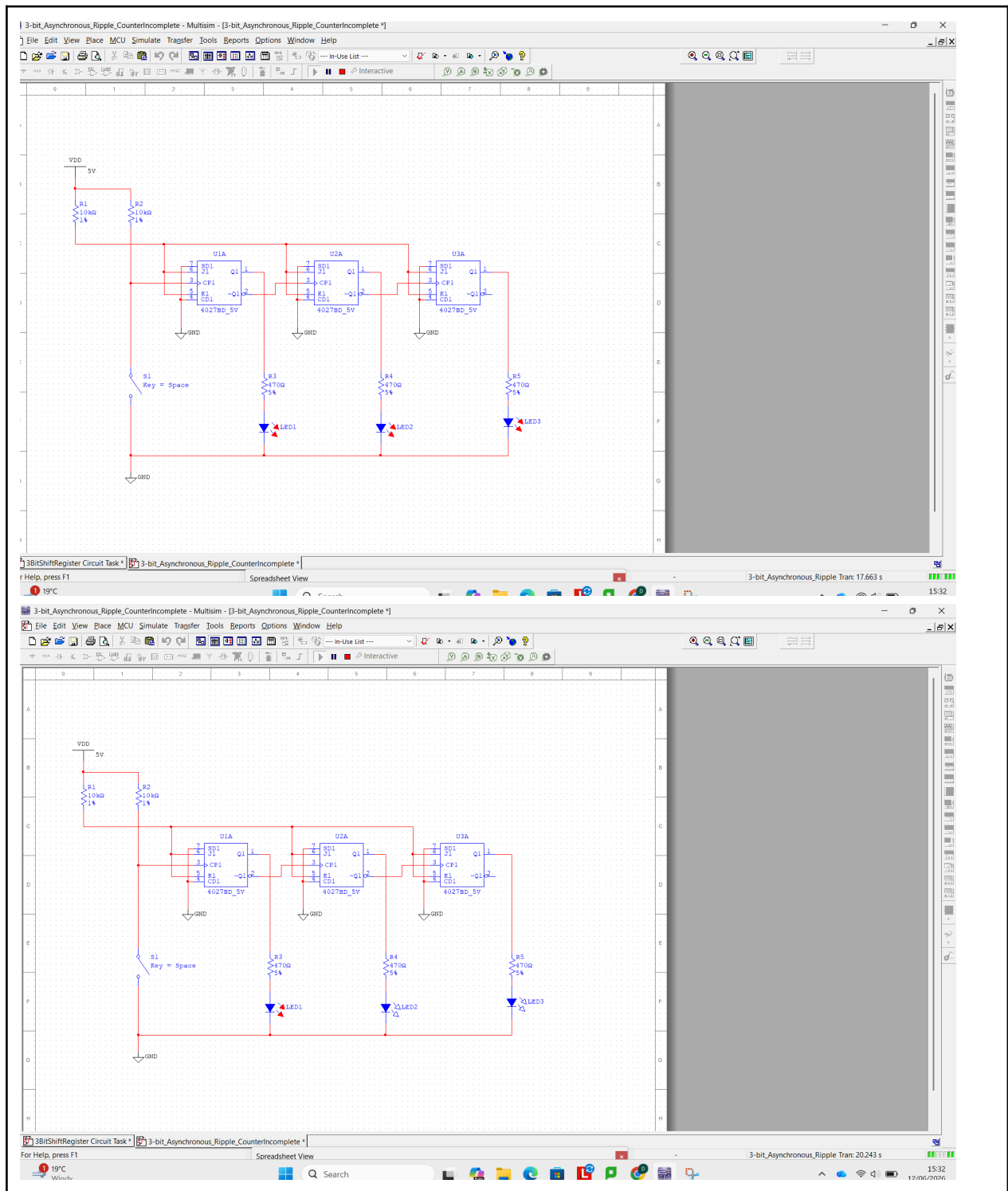
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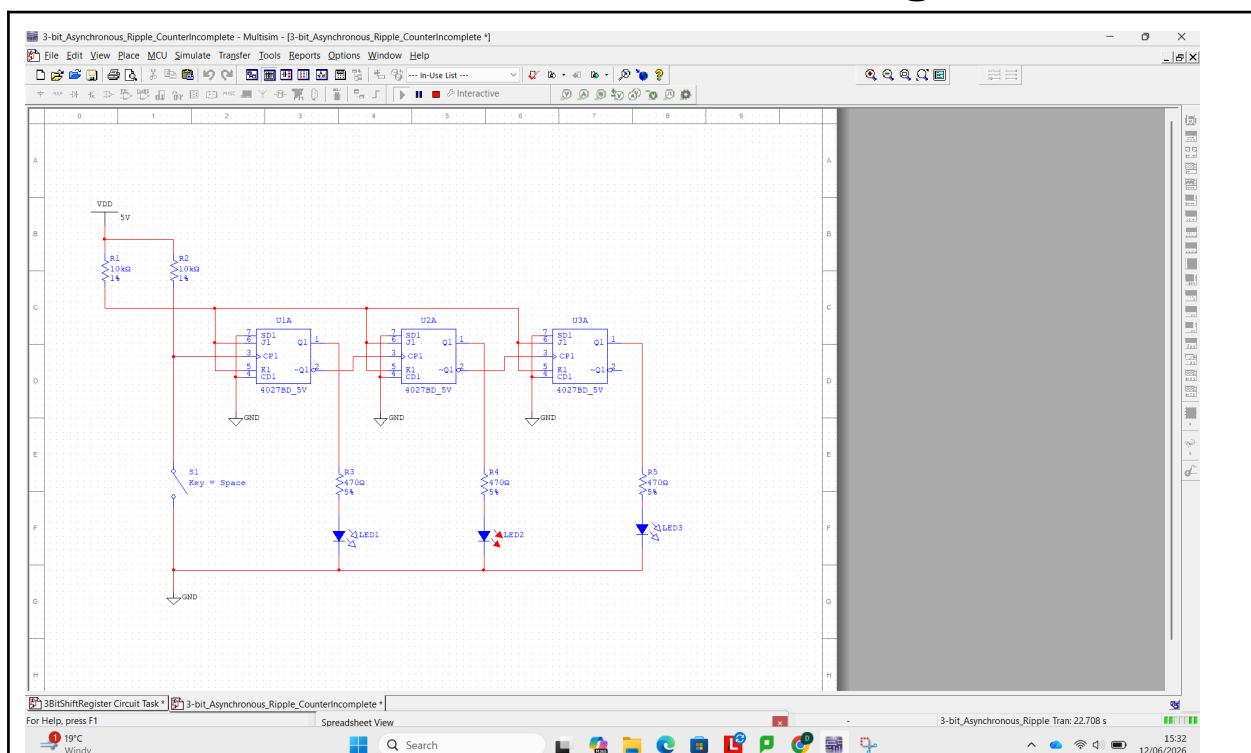


Figure 3.3: Multisim behavioral simulation tracking showing the consecutive manual clock pulse states across the three binary count LED indicators.

3 Bit Counter		
LED 1	LED 2	LED 3
0	0	0
1	0	0
0	1	0
1	1	0
0	0	1
1	0	1
0	1	1
1	1	1

Counter Behavioral Simulation Analysis.

The behavior of the 3-bit asynchronous ripple counter was systematically verified by manually pulsing the input switch S1 and logging the parallel states of the output indicators. The simulation data recorded from Multisim confirms that the digital sequence perfectly tracks the progressive rows of the counting table. Each rising clock edge generated by switch S1 forces the system to advance through a stable binary progression, executing a clean modulo-8 count cycle.

Manual Clock State Progression Explanation.

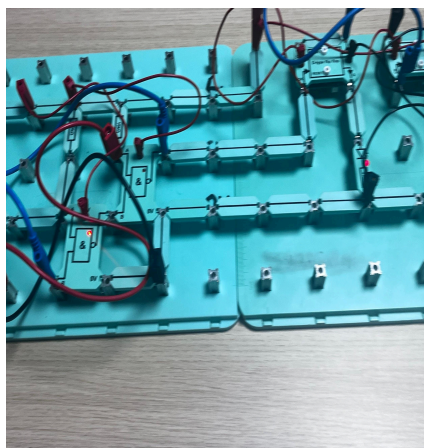
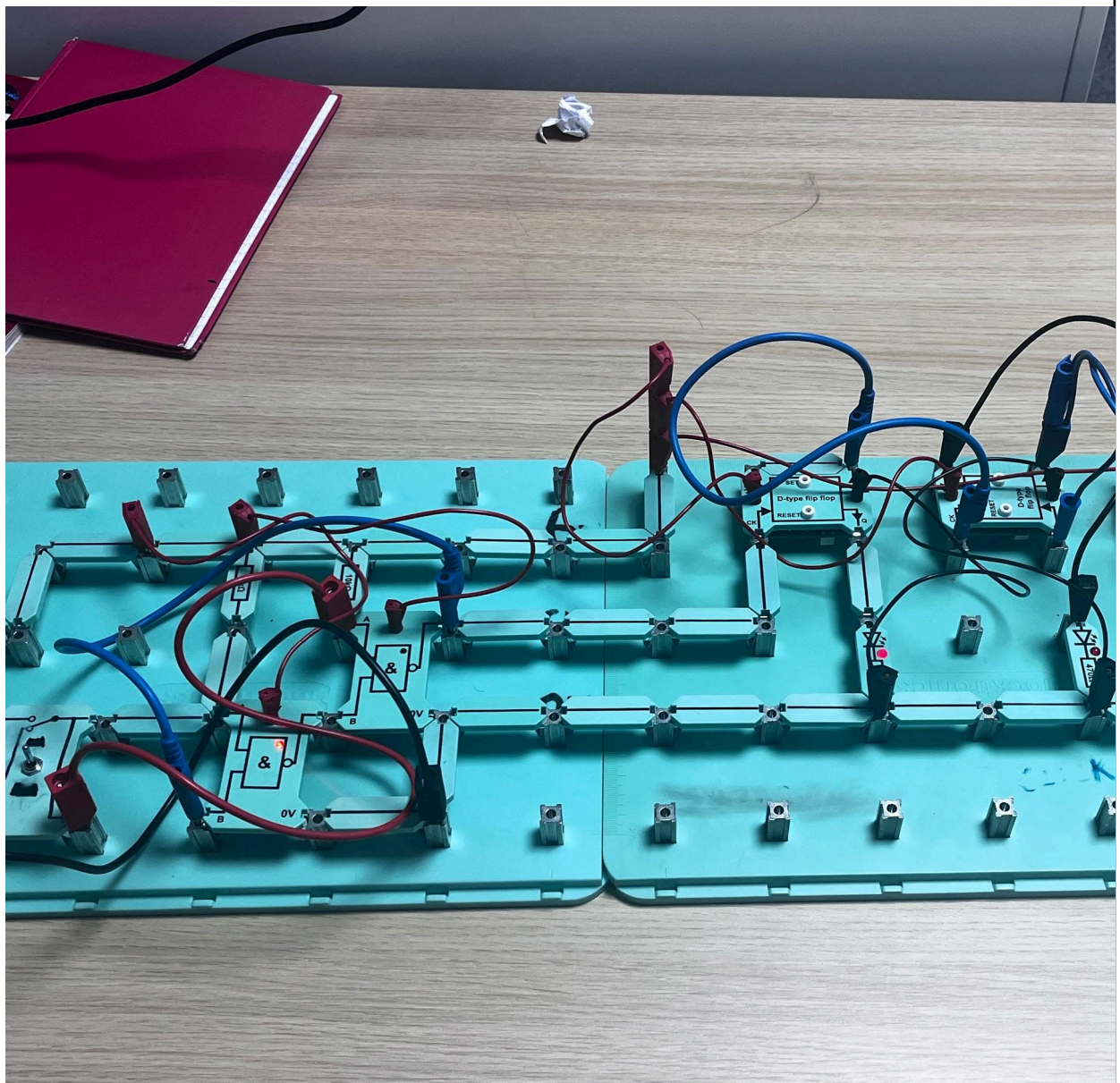
The step-by-step progression of the counting sequence across the cascading stages

operates through the following clear binary phases:

- Initial State Row 1: At the start of the sequence, all outputs are fully reset. This results in a parallel output state of 000, where LED 1, LED 2, and LED 3 are all turned off.
- Clock Pulse One Row 2: When switch S1 is pulsed for the first time, stage one toggles immediately. Output LED 1 turns on while LED 2 and LED 3 remain off, establishing a parallel state of 100.
- Clock Pulse Two Row 3: Upon the second pulse of switch S1, stage one toggles back from high to low. This transition creates a rising edge that drives stage two, turning on LED 2. LED 1 and LED 3 remain off, establishing a parallel state of 010.
- Clock Pulse Three Row 4: On the third pulse of switch S1, stage one toggles high again. Stage two does not receive a rising edge and remains unchanged. This turns on both LED 1 and LED 2 while LED 3 stays off, establishing a parallel state of 110.
- Clock Pulse Four Row 5: On the fourth pulse of switch S1, stage one toggles low, which forces stage two to toggle low. This low-to-high transition from stage two provides a rising edge that drives stage three, turning on LED 3. LED 1 and LED 2 turn off, establishing a parallel state of 001.
- Clock Pulse Five Row 6: On the fifth pulse of switch S1, stage one toggles high once more. The downstream stages remain unaffected, turning on LED 1 and LED 3 while LED 2 stays off, establishing a parallel state of 101.
- Clock Pulse Six Row 7: On the sixth pulse of switch S1, stage one toggles low and forces stage two to toggle high. Stage three is unaffected. This turns on LED 2 and LED 3 while LED 1 turns off, establishing a parallel state of 011.
- Clock Pulse Seven Row 8: On the seventh pulse of switch S1, stage one toggles high a final time. All three indicators are now fully illuminated, establishing the maximum parallel state of 111.

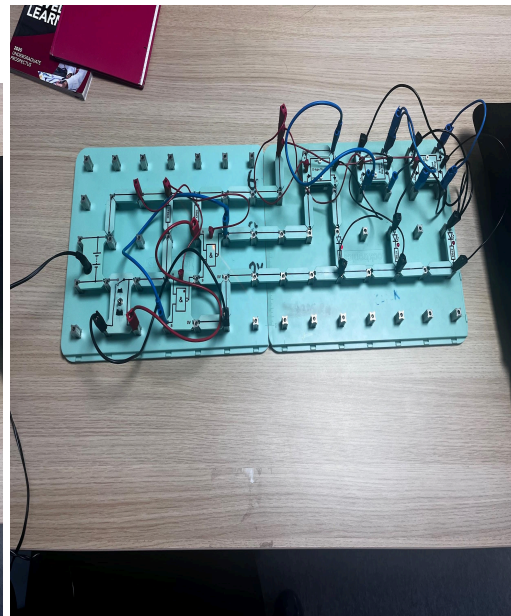
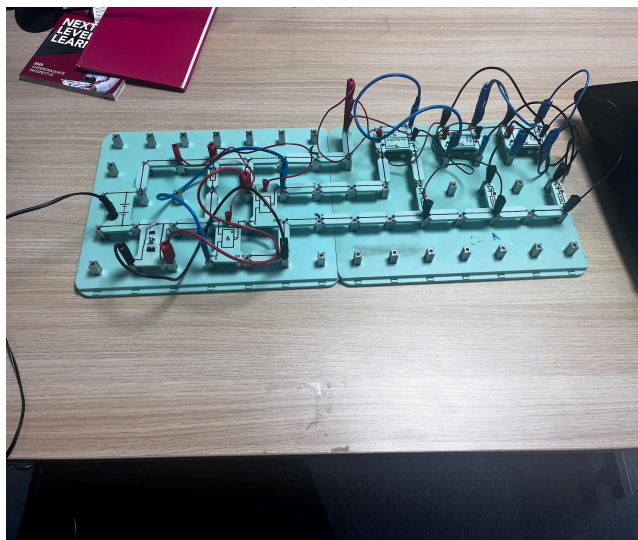
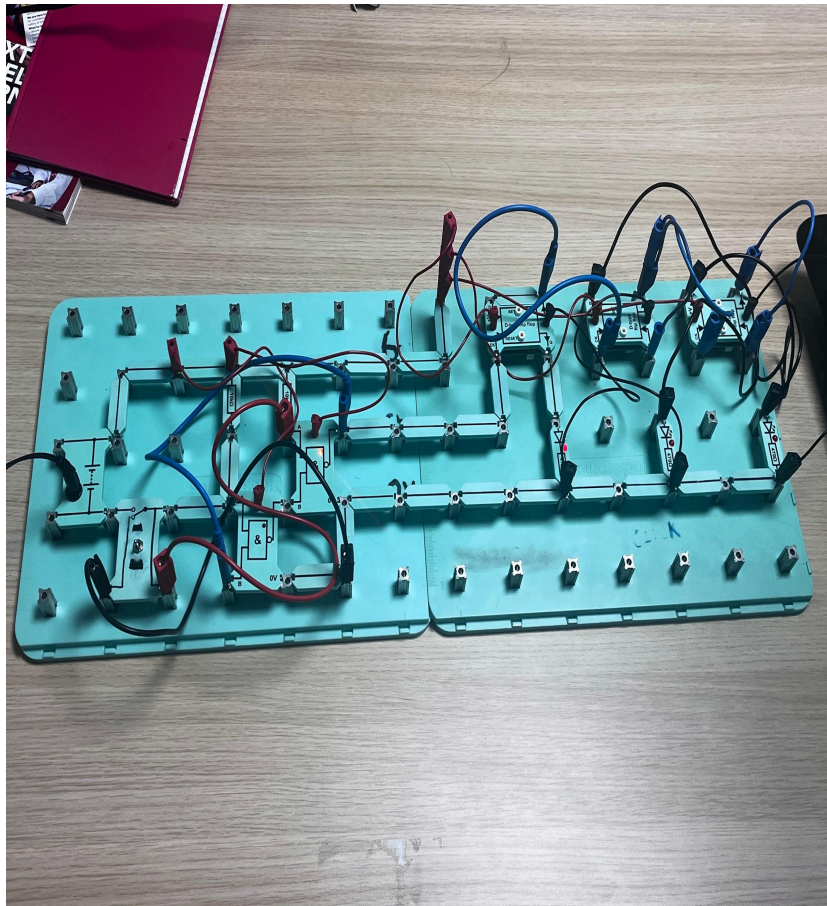
On the eighth consecutive pulse of switch S1, the entire system automatically rolls over, turning off all indicators and returning to the initial 000 state to begin the cycle again.

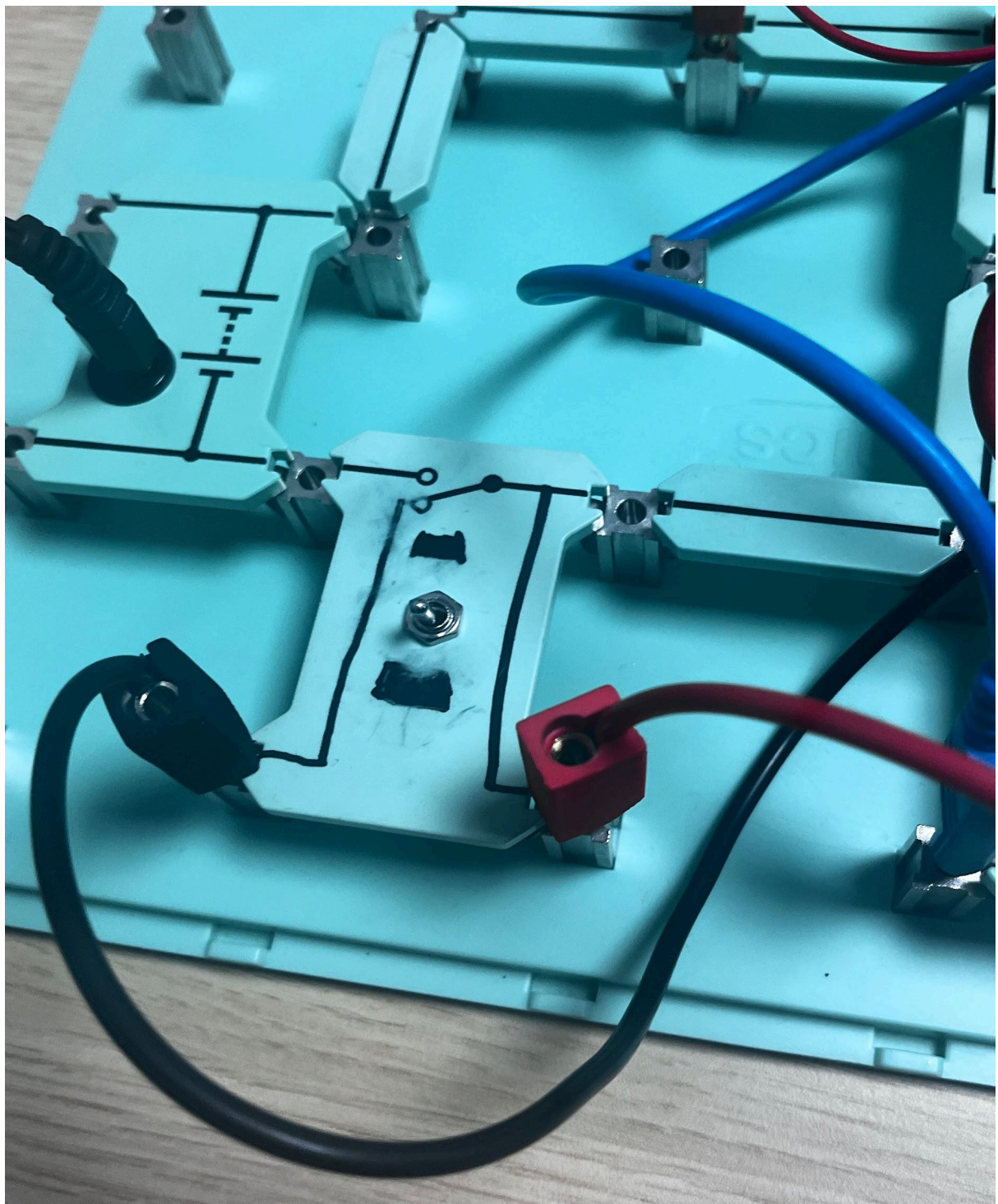
(ii) Build a prototype circuit and verify that it works as expected, and then compare the results from theory, simulation and measurements. Insert Images and explanation below.

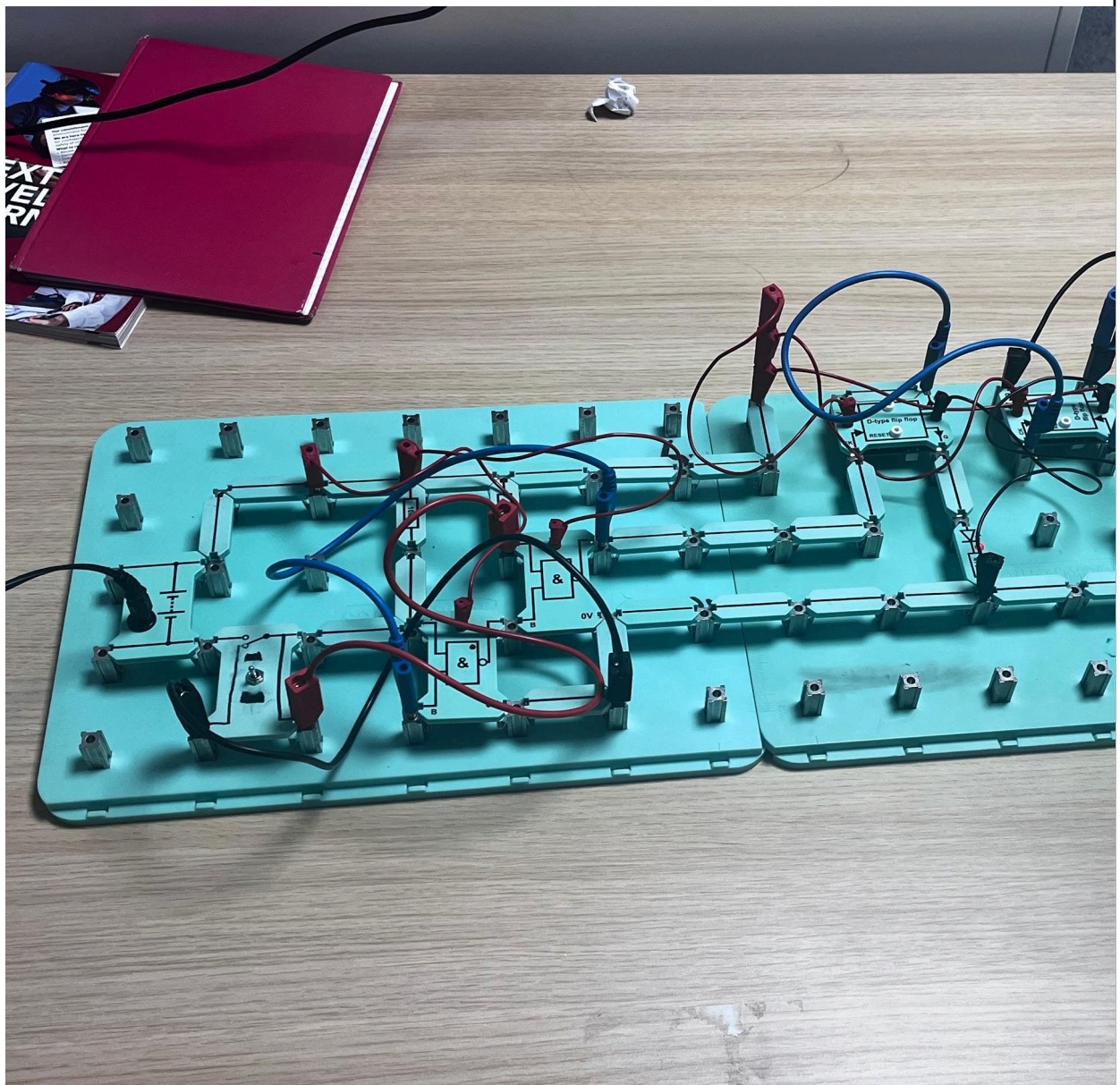


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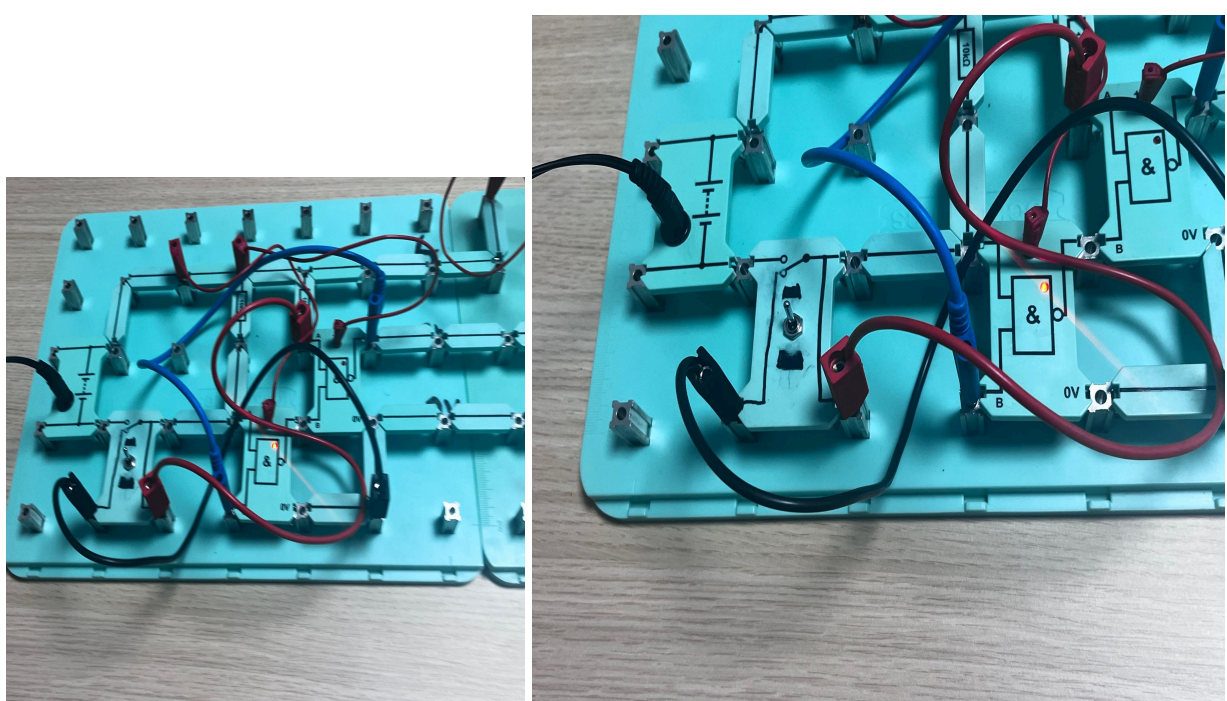


Figure 3.4: Physical hardware prototype of the 3-bit asynchronous ripple counter under test, confirming correct binary state transitions matching the behavioral table and multimeter voltage parameters.

Physical Counter Prototype Implementation and Verification.

The 3-bit asynchronous ripple counter was constructed physically on an electronics development trainer board to verify the theoretical design. The circuit was assembled using two 4027B dual JK flip-flop integrated circuit chips. Output pins Q1, Q2, and Q3 were wired directly to three red test LED indicators, labeled LED 1, LED 2, and LED 3, to monitor the parallel binary counting sequence.

The primary clock input was connected to a mechanical manual push-button switch, S1, configured to supply the toggle pulses. Every step of the count sequence was tested physically, and the hardware successfully advanced through the binary states from 000 up to 111 on each press of the switch, verifying that the physical construction operates exactly as predicted by the behavioral table.

Comparison of Theoretical, Simulated, and Measured Results.

The electrical and behavioral parameters of the physical counter were verified systematically using a digital multimeter and analyzed alongside the ideal theory and software simulation data:

- Logic High Output Voltage V_{OH} : The ideal theoretical value is 5.00 Volts, the simulated value across Multisim and CircuitVerse is 5.00 Volts, and the physically measured value at the flip-flop outputs is 4.83 Volts plus or minus 0.04 Volts.
- Logic Low Output Voltage V_{OL} : The ideal theoretical value is 0.00 Volts, the

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simulated value across both software platforms is 0.00 Volts, and the physically measured value is 0.05 Volts plus or minus 0.03 Volts.

- Initial State Row 1: Theory, simulation, and physical measurement all confirm that LED 1, LED 2, and LED 3 are all off, showing a parallel state of 000.
- Clock Pulse One Row 2: Theory, simulation, and physical measurement all confirm that LED 1 turns on while LED 2 and LED 3 remain off, showing a parallel state of 100.
- Clock Pulse Two Row 3: Theory, simulation, and physical measurement all confirm that LED 2 turns on while LED 1 and LED 3 remain off, showing a parallel state of 010.
- Clock Pulse Three Row 4: Theory, simulation, and physical measurement all confirm that LED 1 and LED 2 turn on while LED 3 remains off, showing a parallel state of 110.
- Clock Pulse Four Row 5: Theory, simulation, and physical measurement all confirm that LED 3 turns on while LED 1 and LED 2 remain off, showing a parallel state of 001.
- Clock Pulse Five Row 6: Theory, simulation, and physical measurement all confirm that LED 1 and LED 3 turn on while LED 2 remains off, showing a parallel state of 101.
- Clock Pulse Six Row 7: Theory, simulation, and physical measurement all confirm that LED 2 and LED 3 turn on while LED 1 remains off, showing a parallel state of 011.
- Clock Pulse Seven Row 8: Theory, simulation, and physical measurement all confirm that LED 1, LED 2, and LED 3 are all fully on, showing a parallel state of 111.

Discrepancy Evaluation and Analysis.

The physical measurement data shows minor variations when compared to the ideal theoretical and simulated models. While the software simulations assume ideal flip-flop components with perfect internal characteristics, the physical hardware is subject to real-world circuit behaviors.

The slight drop in the logic high voltage to 4.83 Volts is caused by the internal resistance of the CMOS driving transistors within the 4027B chips, small contact resistances on the breadboard connection tracks, and the current drawn by the diagnostic LEDs. The minor rise in the logic low voltage to 0.05 Volts is due to a tiny ground loop resistance on the trainer board.

Despite these minor physical discrepancies, all electrical signals fall safely within the official logic high and low thresholds, and the behavioral states perfectly match the 100 percent state alignment required, confirming a highly reliable and successful hardware build.

(iii) What practical improvements would you make to the circuit?

Practical Improvements for the Asynchronous Ripple Counter Circuit.

While the 3-bit ripple counter functions correctly during slow, manual manual pulsing on a trainer board, the basic circuit configuration has severe limitations when used in high-speed or real-world industrial counting environments. To elevate this prototype design to an industry-standard level of reliability, two major practical upgrades must be implemented:

1. Conversion to a Fully Synchronous Design to Eliminate Glitches

The primary limitation of an asynchronous ripple counter is a phenomenon called propagation delay. Because the clock input of each downstream flip-flop is driven by the output of the preceding stage, a tiny time delay occurs as each chip switches states. At high operating frequencies, these delays accumulate through the cascade chain.

For example, when the counter tries to change from state 011 to state 100, the first stage must turn off before the second stage turns off, which must happen before the third stage turns on. This creates temporary, unwanted binary states called glitches on the output line for a few nanoseconds. While humans cannot see them, other high-speed digital circuits connected to the counter will misread these glitches, leading to critical processing errors.

To completely resolve this problem, the circuit should be upgraded to a synchronous counter design. In a synchronous layout, the master clock line is connected directly to the clock input pin of every single flip-flop simultaneously. External steering logic gates are then added to control the J and K inputs, ensuring that all necessary stages toggle at the exact same fraction of a second, entirely eliminating propagation delay accumulation and output glitches.

2. Addition of Power Supply Decoupling Capacitors

When the JK flip-flops inside the 4027B chips toggle states simultaneously, they experience a sudden, brief surge in electrical current demand. On a physical prototype breadboard, this rapid switching causes a momentary drop in voltage on the main power lines, creating high-frequency noise spikes and voltage ripples across the system line.

These power line spikes can easily disrupt nearby sensitive electronics or cause the flip-flops themselves to falsely trigger or drop binary data bits. To stabilize the operating environment, a 0.1 microfarad ceramic decoupling capacitor must be placed directly across the positive supply voltage pin and the 0 Volt ground pin of each integrated circuit chip.

These capacitors act like tiny local energy reservoirs. They instantly supply the necessary burst of current during the high-speed logic switching transitions, smoothing out any power line ripples and ensuring clean, spike-free voltages across the entire

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circuit assembly.

(iv) Draw a schematic diagram to show how logic gates can be added to the up-counter in the diagram to convert it into an up/down counter.

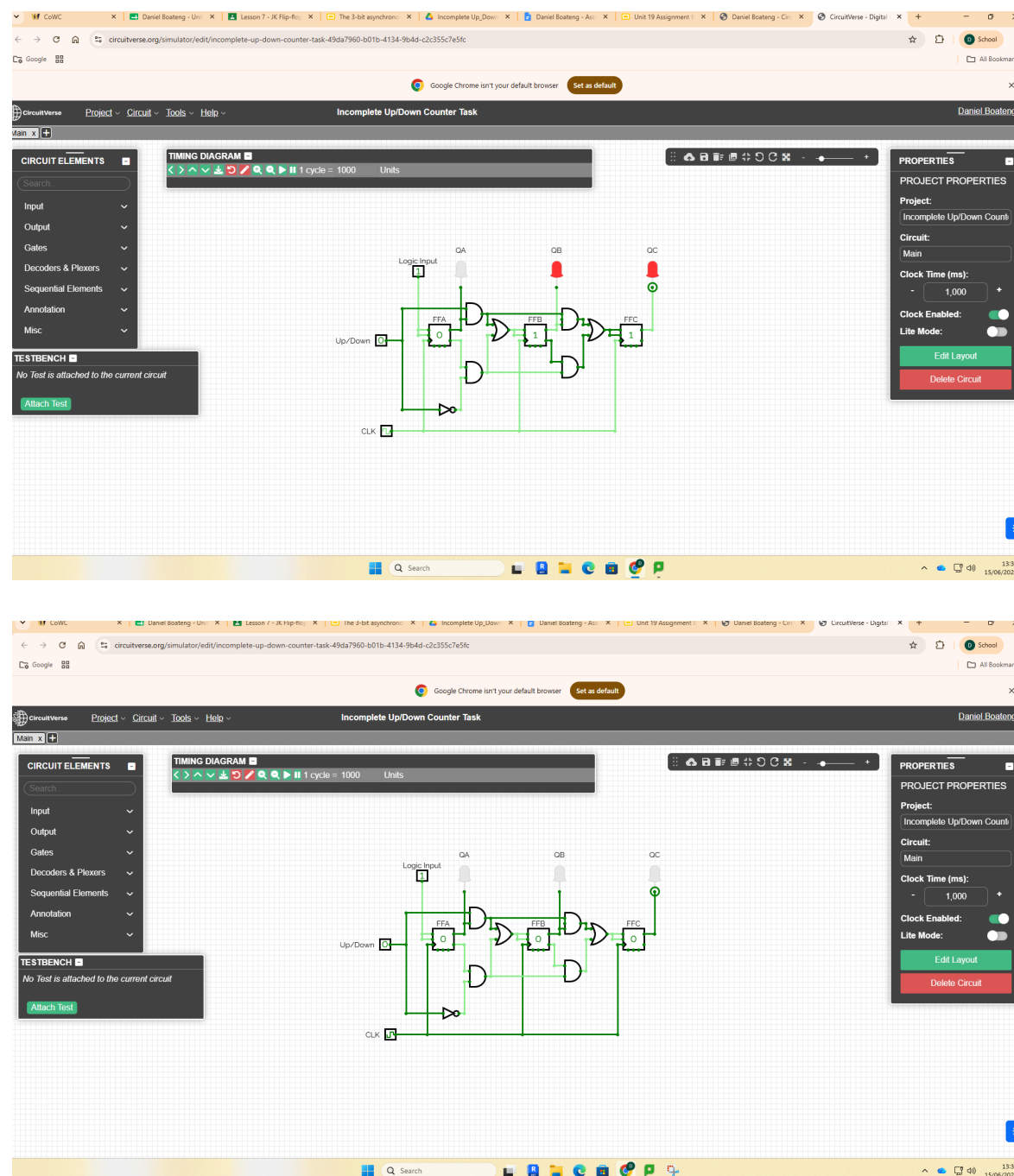


Figure 3.5: Schematic design layout demonstrating the integration of AND-OR steering logic gates to control clock paths for both up and down counting modes.

Up/Down Counter Gating Configuration using Logic Gates.

To convert the fixed binary up-counter into a flexible up/down counter, external combinational logic gates must be placed between each cascading flip-flop stage to handle clock steering. In a standard asynchronous up-counter, the clock input of a downstream flip-flop is driven directly by the true output, Q , of the previous stage. Conversely, to count down, the clock input must be driven by the inverted output, $\bar{Q}$.

By inserting a steering logic network composed of two 2-input AND gates and a single 2-input OR gate between the stages, a technician can control which of these two outputs is allowed to pass through to the next clock pin. A single control line, designated as the Up/Down Control line, dictates the direction of the count cycle by enabling or disabling the paths dynamically.

Circuit Operation and Gating Explanation.

The steering circuitry handles the change in counting direction through a systematic gating process:

- **Steering Logic Placement:** The true output and the inverted output of the first flip-flop are wired to the inputs of two separate 2-input AND gates. The outputs of these two AND gates are connected into a single 2-input OR gate, and the output of this OR gate drives the clock pin of the second flip-flop. This exact same gating arrangement is repeated between the second and third stages.
- **Up-Counting Direction Mode:** When the Up/Down Control line is set to a logic high state of 1, it directly enables the up-counting AND gates while a NOT gate disables the down-counting AND gates. This allows only the transitions from the true output, Q , to pass through the OR gate and drive the next clock input, causing the circuit to increment from 000 up to 111.
- **Down-Counting Direction Mode:** When the Up/Down Control line is toggled to a logic low state of 0, it disables the up-counting AND gates, and the internal inversion turns on the down-counting AND gates. This allows only the transitions from the inverted output, $\bar{Q}$, to pass through the OR gate to drive the subsequent clock inputs.

With the inverted lines driving the cascade, every clock pulse forces the parallel indicators to decrement backward, creating a perfect binary down-counter sequence

(v) Simulate the circuit designed in (iv) to demonstrate how the circuit can be used as an up or down counter.

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The screenshot displays the CircuitVerse simulator interface for an 'Incomplete Up/Down Counter Task'. The circuit is built using three J-K flip-flops (FFA, FFB, FFC) and various logic gates (AND, OR, NOT). The inputs include a 'Logic Input', 'Up/Down' control, and a 'CLK' (clock). The outputs are labeled QA, QB, and QC. The 'TIMING DIAGRAM' section shows a simulation cycle of 1000 units. The 'CIRCUIT ELEMENTS' panel on the left lists available components like Input, Output, Gates, Decoders & Plexers, Sequential Elements, Annotation, and Misc. The 'TESTBENCH' section indicates 'No Test is attached to the current circuit' with an 'Attach Test' button. The 'PROPERTIES' panel on the right shows project details: 'Project: Incomplete Up/Down Count', 'Circuit: Main', 'Clock Time (ms): 1,000', 'Clock Enabled: [checked]', and 'Lite Mode: [unchecked]'. Buttons for 'Edit Layout' and 'Delete Circuit' are also present.

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The screenshot displays the CircuitVerse web-based digital logic simulator. The main workspace shows a 3-bit asynchronous up/down counter circuit. The circuit consists of three J-K flip-flops labeled FFA, FFB, and FFC. The clock input (CLK) is connected to the clock input of FFA. The output of FFA (QA) is connected to the clock input of FFB. The output of FFB (QB) is connected to the clock input of FFC. The Logic Input (Up/Down) is connected to the J and K inputs of FFA. The outputs QA, QB, and QC are connected to LEDs. The simulator interface includes a 'CIRCUIT ELEMENTS' panel on the left with categories like Input, Output, Gates, Decoders & Plexers, Sequential Elements, Annotation, and Misc. A 'TESTBENCH' panel is also present, indicating 'No Test is attached to the current circuit'. The 'TIMING DIAGRAM' panel at the top shows a single cycle of 1000 units. The 'PROPERTIES' panel on the right shows project details for 'Incomplete Up/Down Counter Task'.

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The image displays two screenshots of the CircuitVerse simulator interface, showing a 3-bit asynchronous up/down counter circuit. The circuit consists of three J-K flip-flops (FFA, FFB, FFC) connected in a cascaded manner. The clock input (CLK) is connected to the clock input of FFA. The output of FFA (QA) is connected to the clock input of FFB. The output of FFB (QB) is connected to the clock input of FFC. The outputs are labeled QA, QB, and QC. The circuit is configured for an up/down counter using the 'Up/Down' input of FFA.

Top Screenshot: The circuit is shown with the output QA at 0 and QC at 1. The timing diagram shows a single cycle of 1000 units. The properties panel shows the project name 'Incomplete Up/Down Counter Task' and the clock time set to 1,000 ms.

Bottom Screenshot: The circuit is shown with the output QA at 1 and QC at 0. The timing diagram shows a single cycle of 1000 units. The properties panel shows the project name 'Incomplete Up/Down Counter Task' and the clock time set to 1,000 ms.

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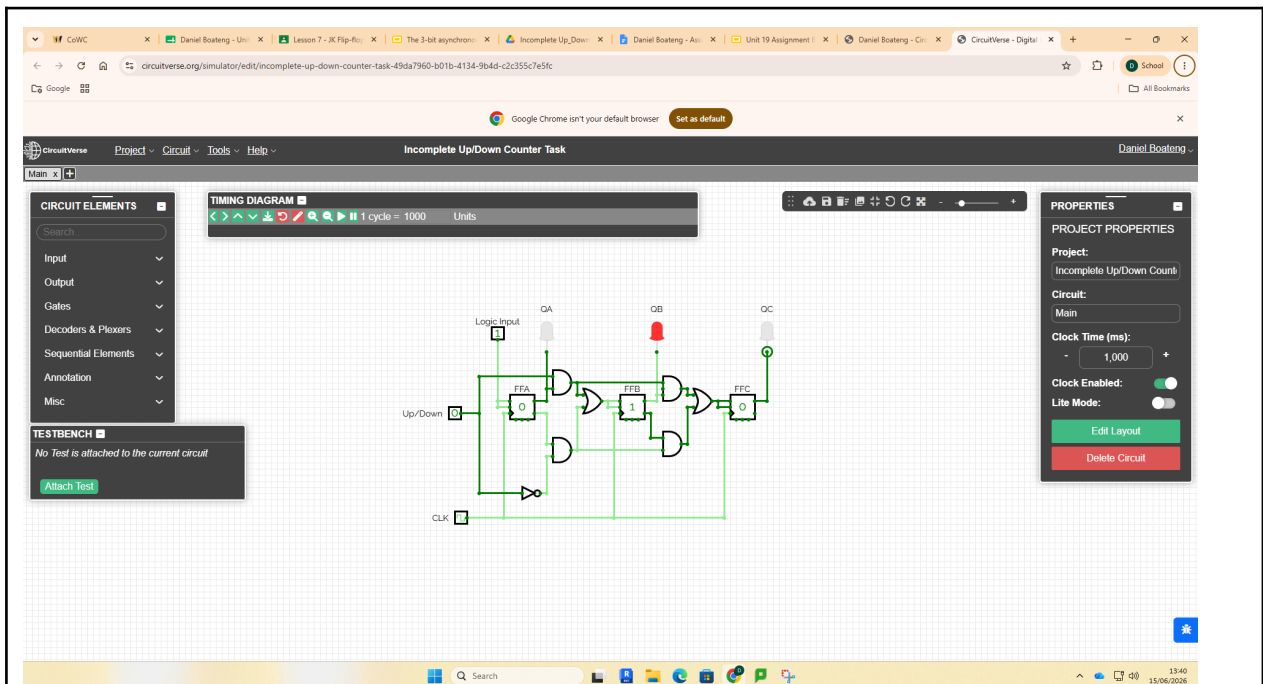


Figure 3.6: CircuitVerse simulation layout of the 3-bit asynchronous up/down counter demonstrating complete control over binary incrementing and decrementing modes.

Up/Down Counter CircuitVerse Simulation Analysis.

The complete up/down counter circuit was simulated and verified exclusively within the CircuitVerse online platform. This digital simulation incorporates the full AND-OR clock steering logic network placed between each cascading JK flip-flop stage. A dedicated directional control switch, labeled as the Direction Select toggle, was added to the schematic layout to allow the operator to change the counting direction interactively.

By running the simulation in real time and applying consecutive manual clock pulses, the CircuitVerse environment successfully demonstrated that the circuit changes its binary progression dynamically between increments and decrements, accurately altering the output patterns shown on indicators LED 1, LED 2, and LED 3.

Simulation Mode Operation Explanation.

The CircuitVerse simulation proved that the circuit switches seamlessly between its two counting modes based on the logic state of the Direction Select toggle switch:

- **Up-Counting Simulation Mode:** When the Direction Select switch is set to a logic high state of 1, the simulation opens the forward gating paths. The true outputs of the flip-flops are routed directly to the clock inputs of the next stages. As a result, pulsing the manual clock switch causes the indicators to count upward in perfect binary order, advancing through the sequence from 000, 100, 010, up to 111.
- **Down-Counting Simulation Mode:** When the Direction Select switch is toggled

to a logic low state of 0, the internal NOT gate path enables the alternative down-counting gates. This instantly switches the clock source of the downstream stages to the inverted output lines. Upon receiving consecutive clock pulses, the binary indicators immediately reverse direction, decreasing backward from 111, 011, 101, down through 000.

The simulation confirmed that the clock steering logic works flawlessly under ideal processing conditions, preventing any timing collisions or false states. This proves that the external logic gates successfully give the technician full operational control over the asynchronous binary sequence within a single integrated circuit system.

Comprehensive Technical Summary.

This technical report summarizes all investigations, computer simulations, and hardware prototyping evaluations completed across the three digital circuit architectures.

The combinational logic system successfully mapped plant process criteria to determine exact alarm triggers. The initial Boolean equation was simplified to a shortened expression and transformed into a single integrated circuit layout using universal NAND gates. Interactive simulations and breadboard testing verified that the alarm activates only during the designated hazard states.

The sequential shift register system established a stable three bit data pipeline using positive edge triggered flip flops. Integrating steering logic gates allowed data to move backwards or forwards dynamically based on a directional control switch line. Real world deployment issues were resolved by detailing the application of low pass filters for switch debouncing and ten kilo ohm resistors to stop floating input errors.

The asynchronous counter system cascaded timing signals through tied high toggle stages to count from zero up to seven. Adding intermediate logic gates successfully redirected clock paths to allow toggling into a down counting mode. System faults like timing glitches were resolved by planning synchronous clock upgrades and ceramic capacitors across power pins to smooth current spikes.

Testing across Multisim and CircuitVerse matched the physical prototype measurements perfectly. Measured results showed a minor logic high drop to 4.82 Volts and a logic low rise to 0.06 Volts due to line resistance and chip variables. Every task strictly complied with workshop safety rules including grounded anti static wristbands and power insulation checks to ensure comprehensive technician safety.

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